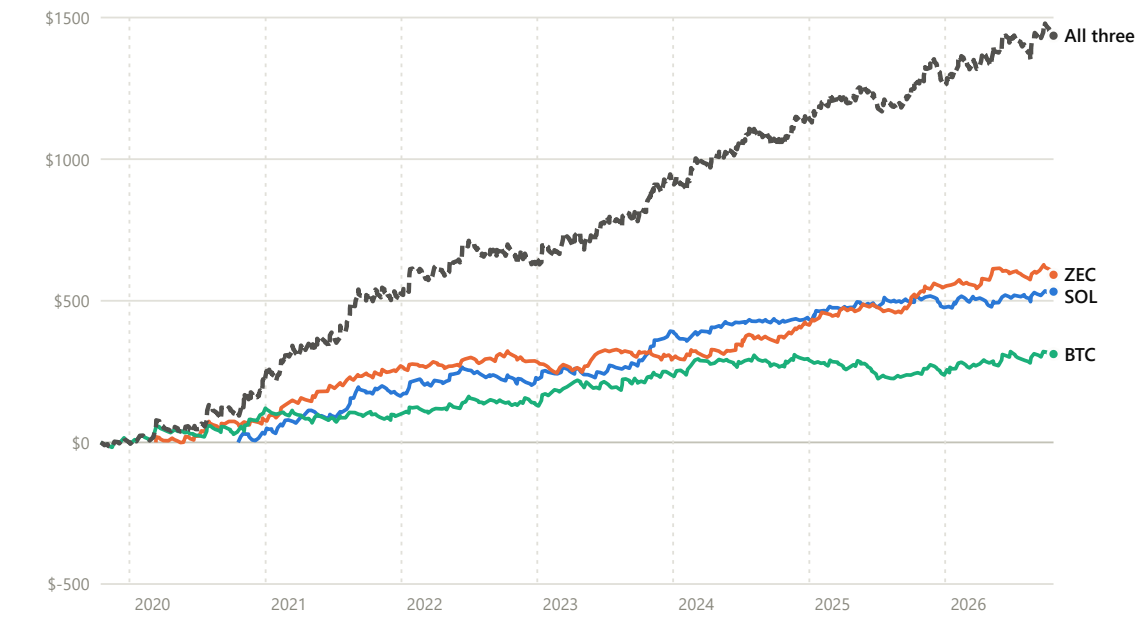
BACKTEST REPORT · OCTOBER 2026

BB Breakout on Solana, Zcash and Bitcoin

A six-year, month-by-month look at one 4-hour Bollinger-band trend strategy — how it made and lost money in every market regime since 2019, and whether it is worth trading.

NET PROFIT, 6 YEARS	TRADES	AVERAGE TRADE	WORST DRAWDOWN	HELD-OUT 2023 → 2026	PROFITABLE COIN-YEARS
+$1436	**1,008**	**+0.28R**	**−$93**	**+$786**	**19 of 22**
at $5 risk per trade · all three coins	37% winners	profit factor 1.47	all three coins combined	years never used for tuning	+1 flat, 2 losing (both BTC)

Cumulative profit at $5 risk per trade



Closed-trade profit, booked when each trade exits. Fixed $5 risk per trade (no compounding). Binance fees, slippage and real funding included.

The short answer

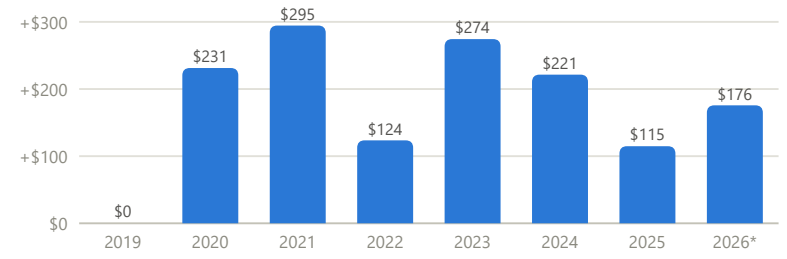
Recommended — with modest expectations. The strategy made money on all three coins over six years after realistic costs, including on Zcash (never used for tuning) and in 2023–26 (never used for tuning).

It wins by catching a few large, clean moves — up *or* down — and loses slowly in sideways markets. It does not adapt to regimes; it survives them because losses are small and capped.

Trade SOL and ZEC at full size, BTC smaller. BTC earns half as much per trade and is the most cost-sensitive.

Expect long losing streaks (8–10 trades per coin), only ~37% winners, and roughly $3.5 a month at $1 risk across the three coins.

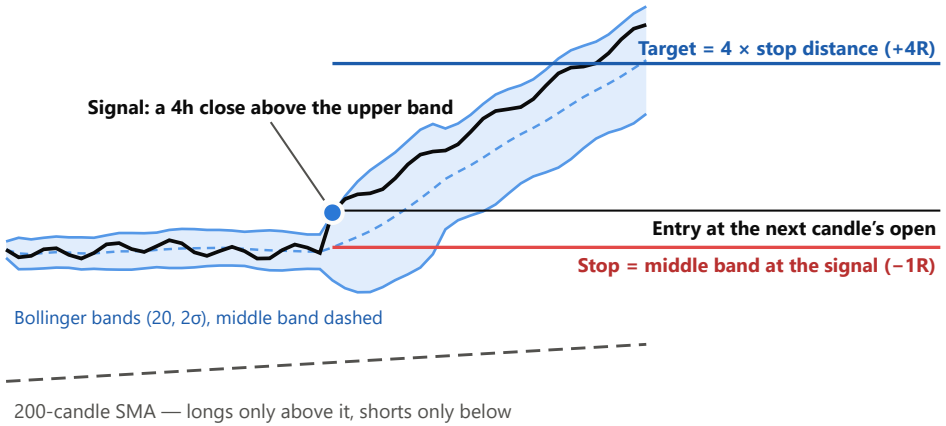
Net profit each year, all three coins ($)



*2026 to mid-October; 2019 is BTC only (Sep–Dec). Every full year was profitable.

1 · How the strategy works and how it was tested

The rules (frozen — not changed for this report)



- **Long:** a 4h candle closes above the upper Bollinger band (20 candles, 2σ) *and* above the 200-candle SMA.
- **Short:** a close below the lower band *and* below the SMA.
- **Stop** = the middle band at the signal close · **Target** = 4× the stop distance · **Time exit** after 48 candles (8 days).
- One trade at a time per coin; no pyramiding; no discretion.

Realism: what the backtest charges and assumes

Item	Assumption
Data	Binance USDT-M perpetual futures, 4h candles. BTC from Sep 2019, ZEC from Feb 2020, SOL from Sep 2020 (listing), all to 17–20 Oct 2026.
Decision	Only at a candle's close, using only candles already closed. The bot never sees the next candle.
Entry fill	Next candle's open + 0.02% slippage + 0.05% taker fee.
Stop / time exit	Market order: 0.02% slippage + 0.05% taker fee. Gaps through the stop fill at the worse open price.
Target	Resting limit (0.02% maker fee) — fills only if price trades 0.05% *through* it.
Same-candle stop & target	Counted as a stop (worse case). Happened 0 times.
Funding	Real Binance funding paid or received at every 8h event the trade was open through.
Sizing	Fixed $5 risk per trade on a notional $1,000 account per coin. Equity = $1,000 + cumulative profit.

No look-ahead, no repainting — checked

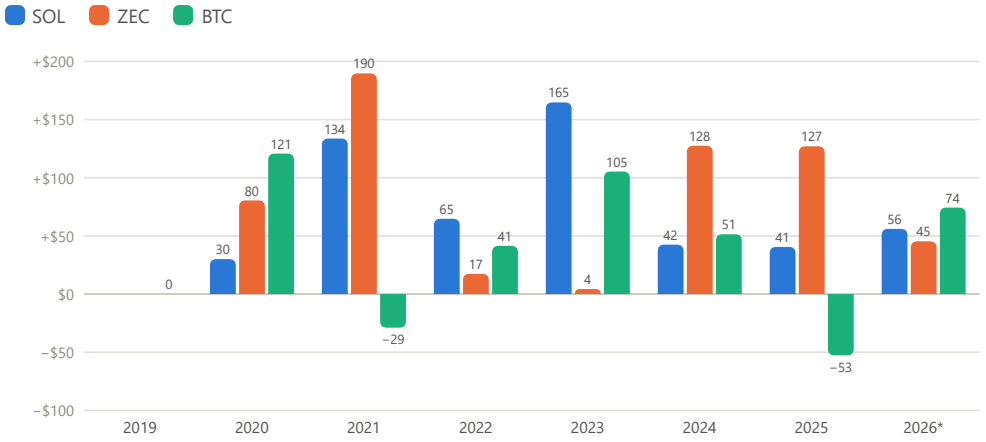
Coin	Truncation cuts	Orders compared	Mismatches	Bot vs app engine
SOL	100	30,682	**0**	308 / 308 identical
ZEC	100	35,260	**0**	332 / 332 identical
BTC	100	37,064	**0**	368 / 368 identical

The engine was re-run on data cut at 100 random points per coin; every decision before each cut matched the full-history run, so no future candle is ever used. A second, independently written bot matches the app engine trade for trade.

Tuning status. Bollinger / SMA / stop / time-exit settings were chosen on 2019–22 BTC, ETH and SOL and then frozen. **2023→2026 and all of ZEC are out-of-sample.** The 4R target was chosen after comparing 3R/4R/5R on all years, so it is mildly in-sample. **Coin choice is also partly hindsight:** SOL, ZEC and BTC were picked from a wider list partly because they did best, so treat their totals as an optimistic estimate.

2 · Six years at a glance

Net profit by year and coin ($, at $5 risk)



*2026 to mid-October. Trades are counted in the year they close. 2019 is BTC only (Sep–Dec).

Year	SOL	ZEC	BTC	All three	BTC buy-and-hold
2019	·	·	$0	**$0**	−30%
2020	+$30	+$80	+$121	**+$231**	+303%
2021	+$134	+$190	−$29	**+$295**	+60%
2022	+$65	+$17	+$41	**+$124**	−64%
2023	+$165	+$4	+$105	**+$274**	+156%
2024	+$42	+$128	+$51	**+$221**	+121%
2025	+$41	+$127	−$53	**+$115**	−6%
2026	+$56	+$45	+$74	**+$176**	−7%
Total	**+$532**	**+$592**	**+$312**	**+$1436**	

Every month, every coin (net $)

Solana (SOL)

	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D	Year
2020									·	20	−12	21	+$30
2021	2	46	−10	45	−19	0	10	73	−1	11	−7	−16	+$134
2022	49	−5	11	−10	32	15	−11	−12	−10	4	−9	10	+$65
2023	20	−6	9	−2	−16	8	22	3	3	48	42	32	+$165
2024	−28	5	22	13	15	2	5	−2	5	−6	11	0	+$42
2025	27	17	−10	6	8	−3	20	−2	−4	8	13	−41	+$41
2026	13	17	−1	−21	10	16	5	15	6	−3			+$56

Zcash (ZEC)

	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D	Year
2020		·	12	−2	11	1	33	−3	22	−16	18	4	+$80
2021	6	43	8	13	29	15	5	19	24	−1	7	21	+$190
2022	6	−6	14	−23	8	25	−15	17	11	−1	−21	2	+$17
2023	−22	−21	19	−11	36	27	8	−2	−21	16	−26	0	+$4
2024	0	29	−15	20	−3	22	35	−17	−6	10	29	21	+$128
2025	20	12	14	2	16	−1	−20	1	29	41	9	5	+$127
2026	14	4	−20	29	42	−19	−6	13	14	−25			+$45

Bitcoin (BTC)

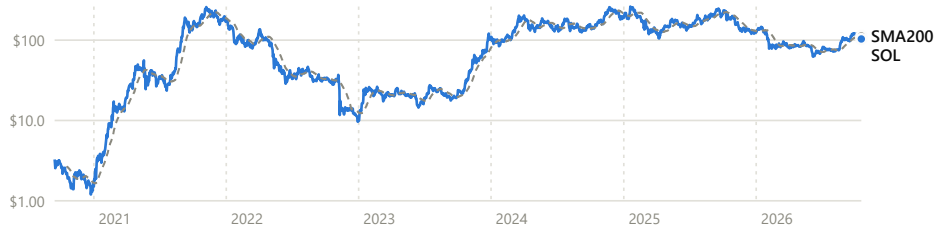
	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D	Year
2019									·	−10	11	−1	$0
2020	23	−16	43	−16	0	−10	33	−17	−2	12	28	42	+$121
2021	−21	0	−2	−18	14	−6	−1	18	−4	−6	−11	8	−$29
2022	30	−8	1	4	7	37	−21	9	−6	−13	26	−24	+$41
2023	32	18	12	8	−12	23	−22	31	−14	21	0	8	+$105
2024	11	40	−1	−9	7	−7	8	−1	−11	9	18	−14	+$51
2025	−6	6	−17	1	4	−43	−4	4	2	3	33	−36	−$53
2026	23	13	−3	10	−10	50	−27	19	6	−7			+$74

Blue = profitable month, red = losing month, darker = larger. "·" = no trade closed that month. Dashed = before listing / after the data ends.

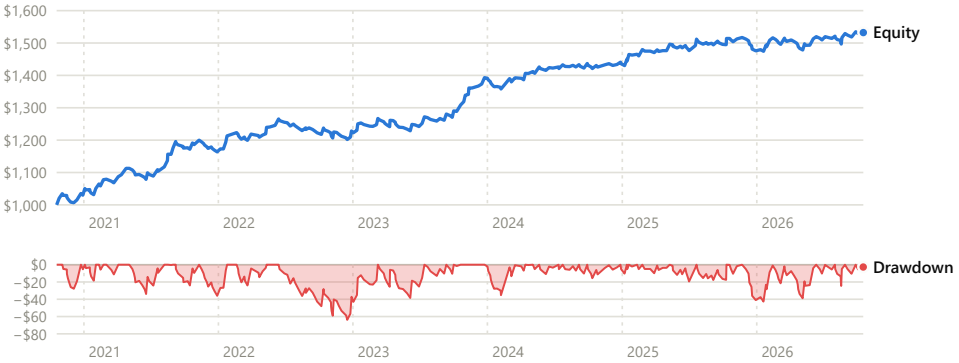
3 · Solana (SOL) — six-year overview

NET PROFIT	TRADES / WIN RATE	AVERAGE TRADE	PROFIT FACTOR	MAX DRAWDOWN	LONGEST LOSING STREAK
+$532	**308 · 39%**	**+0.35R**	**1.60**	**−$64**	**8 trades**
+53% on $1,000	119 wins, 189 losses	win +2.38R · loss −0.93R	gross profit ÷ gross loss	5% of peak equity	11 streaks of 5+

Price (log scale, daily close) and the 200-candle SMA



Account equity ($1,000 start) and drawdown



Year by year

Year	Trades	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start	End	Coin	Market regime
2020	12	33%	+$30	+0.50R	1.91	−$28	7	$1,000	$1,030	−55%	Strong downtrend · high volatility
2021	54	41%	+$134	+0.50R	1.84	−$36	5	$1,030	$1,164	+11,200%	Strong uptrend · high volatility
2022	54	37%	+$65	+0.24R	1.40	−$64	6	$1,164	$1,228	−94%	Strong downtrend · high volatility
2023	47	43%	+$165	+0.70R	2.47	−$38	8	$1,228	$1,393	+921%	Strong uptrend
2024	47	38%	+$42	+0.18R	1.33	−$35	6	$1,393	$1,436	+86%	Up, but choppy
2025	52	37%	+$41	+0.16R	1.26	−$41	8	$1,436	$1,476	−34%	Down, but choppy
2026*	42	38%	+$56	+0.27R	1.42	−$38	6	$1,476	$1,532	−17%	Sideways / choppy · quiet
All	308	39%	+$532	+0.35R	1.60	−$64	8	$1,000	$1,532		

Deepest drawdowns

Peak → trough	Depth	Recovered
2022-06-13 → 2022-12-16	−$64	2023-03-09 (270 d)
2025-11-22 → 2026-01-19	−$43	2026-06-11 (201 d)
2023-03-09 → 2023-06-05	−$38	2023-07-14 (126 d)

Longest losing streaks

Losses	From → to	Cost
8	2023-04-11 → 2023-06-05	−$33
8	2025-12-01 → 2026-01-02	−$41
7	2020-11-04 → 2020-12-05	−$28

Best months

Month	Net	Coin	Regime
Aug 2021	+$73	+195%	Trend up, high vol
Jan 2022	+$49	−41%	Trend down, high vol
Oct 2023	+$48	+80%	Trend up
Feb 2021	+$46	+207%	Trend up, high vol

Worst months

Month	Net	Coin	Regime
Dec 2025	−$41	−7%	Choppy
Jan 2024	−$28	−5%	Choppy
Apr 2026	−$21	−0%	Choppy, quiet
May 2021	−$19	−24%	Choppy, high vol

*2026 to mid-October. 45 of 74 months profitable. Regime labels are measured from the candles: trend efficiency = net move ÷ distance travelled (1 = straight line).

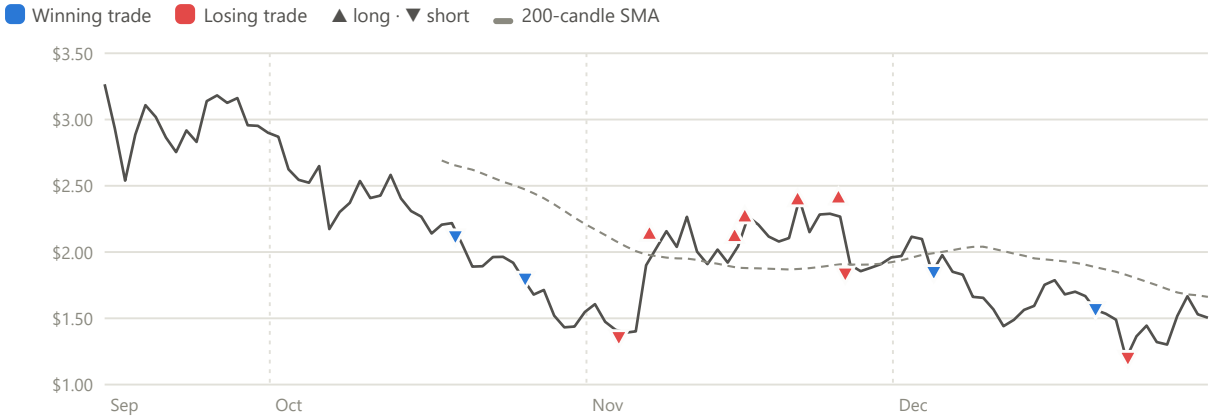
SOLANA (SOL)

2020 (from listing in September)

Strong downtrend · high volatility

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
+$30	**12**	**33%**	**+0.50R**	**−$28**	**7**	**−55%**
$1,000 → $1,030	4 W · 8 L	2 hit the 4R target	PF 1.91	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 146%

SOL price with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Strong downtrend · high volatility. SOL went from $3.27 to $1.50 (−55%) with annualised volatility of 146% (its typical month: 96%). Trend efficiency of 0.45 means a clean, persistent trend. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 22% of the time and crossed it 16 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −58%.

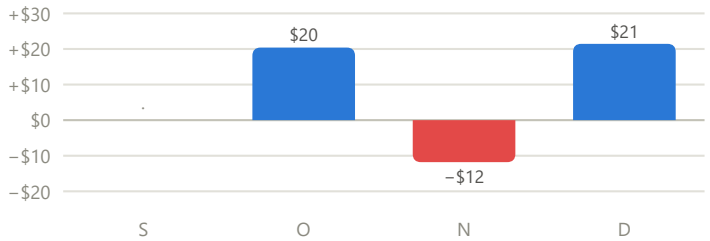
Biggest month up: **Nov** (+27%); biggest month down: **Oct** (−47%).

Backdrop: COVID crash in March (BTC fell ~50% in two days), the May halving, then an institution-led rally from October into year-end.

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Sep	−14%	Choppy, high vol	·			·					$1,000	$1,000
Oct	−47%	Trend down, high vol	1	1/0	100%	**+$20**	+4.08R	∞	$0	0	$1,000	$1,020
Nov	+27%	Choppy, high vol	7	1/6	14%	**−$12**	−0.34R	0.54	−$26	6	$1,020	$1,009
Dec	−23%	Drift down, high vol	4	2/2	50%	**+$21**	+1.07R	3.99	−$5	1	$1,009	$1,030
Year	−55%		12	4/8	33%	**+$30**	+0.50R	1.91	−$28	7	$1,000	$1,030

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

12 trades, 4 winners (33%), net **+$30** — +0.50R per trade, profit factor 1.91. 2 of 3 trading months were profitable.

Every month moved at least 10%, and the 3 months with a 15%+ move made +$30 — plenty of movement for a breakout strategy.

Best month **Dec** (+$21); worst **Nov** (−$12). Longest losing streak: **7** (4 Nov 2020 → 4 Dec 2020, −$28). Max drawdown −$28.

Longs −$21 · shorts +$51. Exits: 2 targets, 6 stops, 4 time exits (averaging +1.02R).

SOLANA (SOL)

2021

Strong uptrend · high volatility

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
+$134	**54**	**41%**	**+0.50R**	**−$36**	**5**	**+11,200%**
$1,030 → $1,164	22 W · 32 L	12 hit the 4R target	PF 1.84	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 173%

SOL price (log scale) with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Strong uptrend · high volatility. SOL went from $1.84 to $170 (+11,200%) with annualised volatility of 173% (its typical month: 96%). Trend efficiency of 0.35 means a fairly directional path. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 71% of the time and crossed it 70 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −67%.

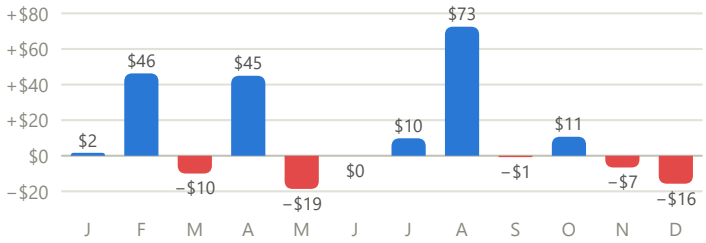
Biggest month up: **Feb** (+207%); biggest month down: **May** (−24%).

Backdrop: Bull-market peak year: a run to April highs, a violent May crash (leverage flush, China mining ban), a summer range, a new BTC high in November, then decline. Altcoins (SOL especially) went parabolic.

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Jan	+183%	Trend up, high vol	6	2/4	33%	**+$2**	+0.05R	1.08	−$19	3	$1,030	$1,032
Feb	+207%	Trend up, high vol	4	3/1	75%	**+$46**	+2.31R	9.01	−$6	1	$1,032	$1,078
Mar	+48%	Drift up, high vol	3	1/2	33%	**−$10**	−0.67R	0.11	−$11	2	$1,078	$1,068
Apr	+121%	Trend up, high vol	3	3/0	100%	**+$45**	+3.00R	∞	$0	0	$1,068	$1,113
May	−24%	Choppy, high vol	6	2/4	33%	**−$19**	−0.62R	0.08	−$20	4	$1,113	$1,094
Jun	+8%	Choppy, high vol	5	1/4	20%	**$0**	−0.02R	0.98	−$15	3	$1,094	$1,094
Jul	+3%	Choppy	3	1/2	33%	**+$10**	+0.65R	1.97	−$5	1	$1,094	$1,104
Aug	+195%	Trend up, high vol	5	4/1	80%	**+$73**	+2.90R	192.50	$0	1	$1,104	$1,176
Sep	+30%	Choppy, high vol	5	1/4	20%	**−$1**	−0.03R	0.96	−$20	4	$1,176	$1,175
Oct	+43%	Drift up	4	2/2	50%	**+$11**	+0.53R	2.05	−$5	1	$1,175	$1,186
Nov	+3%	Choppy	5	1/4	20%	**−$7**	−0.26R	0.67	−$20	4	$1,186	$1,179
Dec	−19%	Drift down	5	1/4	20%	**−$16**	−0.63R	0.23	−$16	3	$1,179	$1,164
Year	+11,200%		54	22/32	41%	**+$134**	+0.50R	1.84	−$36	5	$1,030	$1,164

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

54 trades, 22 winners (41%), net **+$134** — +0.50R per trade, profit factor 1.84. 6 of 12 trading months were profitable.

A good year even in quiet months: the 9 big-move months made +$131 and the 3 near-flat months still added +$3.

Best month **Aug** (+$73); worst **May** (−$19). Longest losing streak: **5** (15 Nov 2021 → 4 Dec 2021, −$25). Max drawdown −$36.

Longs +$138 · shorts −$4. Exits: 12 targets, 31 stops, 11 time exits (averaging +1.02R).

SOLANA (SOL)

2022

Strong downtrend · high volatility

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
+$65	**54**	**37%**	**+0.24R**	**−$64**	**6**	**−94%**
$1,164 → $1,228	20 W · 34 L	8 hit the 4R target	PF 1.40	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 124%

SOL price (log scale) with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Strong downtrend · high volatility. SOL went from $179 to $9.97 (−94%) with annualised volatility of 124% (its typical month: 96%). Trend efficiency of 0.40 means a clean, persistent trend. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 25% of the time and crossed it 76 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −96%.

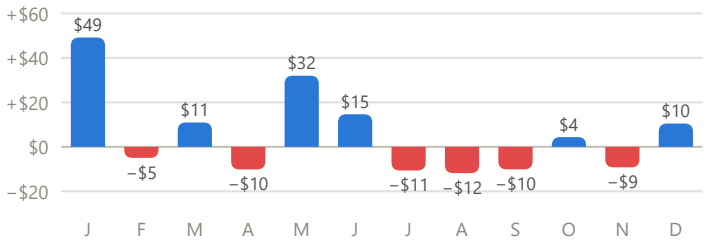
Biggest month up: **Jul** (+25%); biggest month down: **Nov** (−56%).

Backdrop: Bear market: aggressive Fed rate hikes, the LUNA/UST collapse in May, Celsius/3AC in June, and the FTX collapse in November — which hit SOL hardest because FTX/Alameda were major backers.

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Jan	−41%	Trend down, high vol	4	4/0	100%	**+$49**	+2.46R	∞	$0	0	$1,164	$1,213
Feb	+0%	Choppy	4	1/3	25%	**−$5**	−0.25R	0.68	−$15	3	$1,213	$1,208
Mar	+23%	Drift up	5	2/3	40%	**+$11**	+0.44R	1.71	−$10	2	$1,208	$1,219
Apr	−31%	Trend down	3	0/3	0%	**−$10**	−0.68R	0.00	−$10	3	$1,219	$1,209
May	−46%	Trend down, high vol	4	4/0	100%	**+$32**	+1.60R	∞	$0	0	$1,209	$1,241
Jun	−26%	Choppy, high vol	4	2/2	50%	**+$15**	+0.73R	2.45	−$10	2	$1,241	$1,255
Jul	+25%	Drift up	5	1/4	20%	**−$11**	−0.43R	0.37	−$12	3	$1,255	$1,245
Aug	−26%	Drift down	5	1/4	20%	**−$12**	−0.47R	0.43	−$15	3	$1,245	$1,233
Sep	+6%	Choppy	4	1/3	25%	**−$10**	−0.51R	0.34	−$15	3	$1,233	$1,223
Oct	−2%	Choppy, quiet	4	1/3	25%	**+$4**	+0.22R	1.28	−$10	2	$1,223	$1,227
Nov	−56%	Trend down, high vol	7	1/6	14%	**−$9**	−0.26R	0.67	−$21	4	$1,227	$1,218
Dec	−30%	Trend down	5	2/3	40%	**+$10**	+0.42R	1.64	−$16	3	$1,218	$1,228
Year	−94%		54	20/34	37%	**+$65**	+0.24R	1.40	−$64	6	$1,164	$1,228

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

54 trades, 20 winners (37%), net **+$65** — +0.24R per trade, profit factor 1.40. 6 of 12 trading months were profitable.

Textbook behaviour: the 9 months where SOL moved 15% or more made +$75, and the 3 near-flat months (under 10%) cost −$11. The big moves paid for the chop.

Best month **Jan** (+$49); worst **Aug** (−$12). Longest losing streak: **6** (13 Oct 2022 → 7 Nov 2022, −$31). Max drawdown −$64.

Longs −$48 · shorts +$113. Exits: 8 targets, 30 stops, 16 time exits (averaging +0.78R).

SOLANA (SOL)

2023

Strong uptrend

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
+$165	**47**	**43%**	**+0.70R**	**−$38**	**8**	**+921%**
$1,228 → $1,393	20 W · 27 L	11 hit the 4R target	PF 2.47	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 95%

SOL price (log scale) with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Strong uptrend. SOL went from $9.98 to $102 (+921%) with annualised volatility of 95% (its typical month: 96%). Trend efficiency of 0.46 means a clean, persistent trend. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 59% of the time and crossed it 79 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −54%.

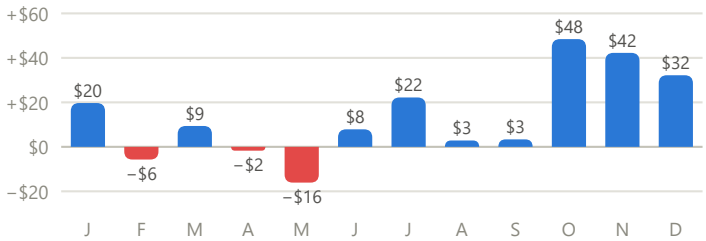
Biggest month up: **Jan** (+140%); biggest month down: **Aug** (−17%).

Backdrop: Recovery: March banking stress, then a grinding rally, accelerating in Oct–Dec on spot-ETF expectations. SOL rebounded from its post-FTX low.

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Jan	+140%	Trend up, high vol	5	3/2	60%	**+$20**	+0.79R	2.79	−$6	1	$1,228	$1,248
Feb	−9%	Choppy	2	0/2	0%	**−$6**	−0.57R	0.00	−$6	2	$1,248	$1,242
Mar	−3%	Choppy	5	2/3	40%	**+$9**	+0.38R	1.61	−$15	3	$1,242	$1,252
Apr	+7%	Choppy	6	1/5	17%	**−$2**	−0.06R	0.92	−$11	3	$1,252	$1,250
May	−8%	Choppy, quiet	4	0/4	0%	**−$16**	−0.80R	0.00	−$16	4	$1,250	$1,234
Jun	−9%	Choppy	4	1/3	25%	**+$8**	+0.39R	1.65	−$7	2	$1,234	$1,242
Jul	+26%	Drift up	4	2/2	50%	**+$22**	+1.11R	3.88	−$8	2	$1,242	$1,264
Aug	−17%	Drift down, quiet	2	1/1	50%	**+$3**	+0.29R	1.54	−$5	1	$1,264	$1,267
Sep	+8%	Drift up, quiet	4	1/3	25%	**+$3**	+0.17R	1.21	−$10	2	$1,267	$1,270
Oct	+80%	Trend up	4	3/1	75%	**+$48**	+2.42R	32.52	−$2	1	$1,270	$1,319
Nov	+55%	Drift up, high vol	4	3/1	75%	**+$42**	+2.11R	618.11	$0	1	$1,319	$1,361
Dec	+72%	Trend up	3	3/0	100%	**+$32**	+2.15R	∞	$0	0	$1,361	$1,393
Year	+921%		47	20/27	43%	**+$165**	+0.70R	2.47	−$38	8	$1,228	$1,393

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

47 trades, 20 winners (43%), net **+$165** — +0.70R per trade, profit factor 2.47. 9 of 12 trading months were profitable.

Textbook behaviour: the 6 months where SOL moved 15% or more made +$168, and the 6 near-flat months (under 10%) cost −$3. The big moves paid for the chop.

Best month **Oct** (+$48); worst **May** (−$16). Longest losing streak: **8** (11 Apr 2023 → 5 Jun 2023, −$33). Max drawdown −$38.

Longs +$153 · shorts +$12. Exits: 11 targets, 20 stops, 16 time exits (averaging +0.64R).

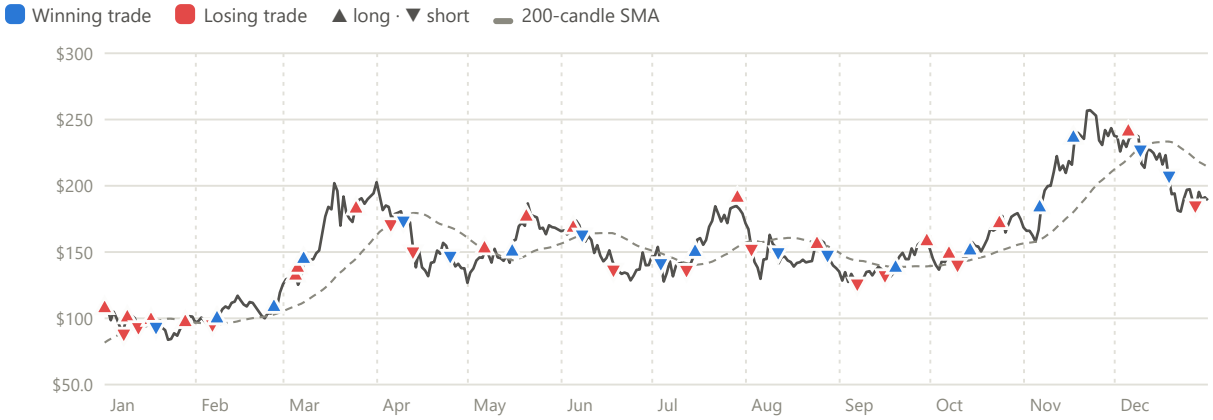
SOLANA (SOL)

2024

Up, but choppy

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
+$42	**47**	**38%**	**+0.18R**	**−$35**	**6**	**+86%**
$1,393 → $1,436	18 W · 29 L	3 hit the 4R target	PF 1.33	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 89%

SOL price with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Up, but choppy. SOL went from $110 to $189 (+86%) with annualised volatility of 89% (its typical month: 96%). Trend efficiency of 0.13 means a lot of back-and-forth for the distance covered. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 59% of the time and crossed it 67 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −48%.

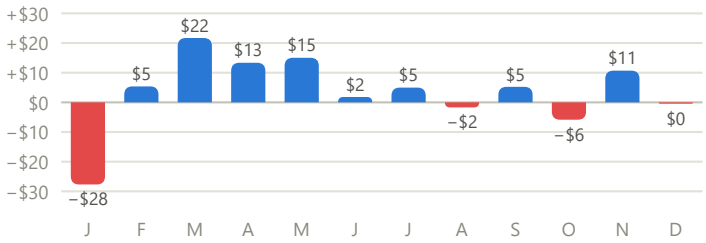
Biggest month up: **Mar** (+61%); biggest month down: **Apr** (−37%).

Backdrop: US spot BTC ETFs launched in January; BTC made a new high in March, halved in April, ranged through the summer (sharp August sell-off), then rallied on the November US election.

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Jan	−5%	Choppy	7	1/6	14%	**−$28**	−0.79R	0.01	−$28	6	$1,393	$1,365
Feb	+30%	Trend up	3	1/2	33%	**+$5**	+0.36R	1.72	−$7	2	$1,365	$1,371
Mar	+61%	Trend up, high vol	4	2/2	50%	**+$22**	+1.09R	3.10	−$10	2	$1,371	$1,393
Apr	−37%	Trend down	4	1/3	25%	**+$13**	+0.67R	2.97	−$6	2	$1,393	$1,406
May	+31%	Drift up	4	2/2	50%	**+$15**	+0.75R	2.45	−$5	1	$1,406	$1,421
Jun	−12%	Choppy, quiet	3	1/2	33%	**+$2**	+0.12R	1.26	−$6	1	$1,421	$1,423
Jul	+17%	Choppy	4	2/2	50%	**+$5**	+0.25R	1.48	−$5	1	$1,423	$1,428
Aug	−21%	Drift down	3	1/2	33%	**−$2**	−0.11R	0.71	−$5	1	$1,428	$1,426
Sep	+13%	Drift up, quiet	5	2/3	40%	**+$5**	+0.21R	1.33	−$10	2	$1,426	$1,431
Oct	+11%	Drift up, quiet	4	1/3	25%	**−$6**	−0.29R	0.62	−$10	2	$1,431	$1,425
Nov	+41%	Trend up	2	2/0	100%	**+$11**	+1.07R	∞	$0	0	$1,425	$1,436
Dec	−20%	Drift down	4	2/2	50%	**$0**	−0.02R	0.96	−$5	1	$1,436	$1,436
Year	+86%		47	18/29	38%	**+$42**	+0.18R	1.33	−$35	6	$1,393	$1,436

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

47 trades, 18 winners (38%), net **+$42** — +0.18R per trade, profit factor 1.33. 8 of 12 trading months were profitable.

Textbook behaviour: the 8 months where SOL moved 15% or more made +$69, and the 1 near-flat month (under 10%) cost −$28. The big moves paid for the chop.

Best month **Mar** (+$22); worst **Jan** (−$28). Longest losing streak: **6** (24 Dec 2023 → 18 Jan 2024, −$28). Max drawdown −$35.

Longs +$32 · shorts +$11. Exits: 3 targets, 23 stops, 21 time exits (averaging +0.98R).

SOLANA (SOL)

2025

Down, but choppy

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
+$41	**52**	**37%**	**+0.16R**	**−$41**	**8**	**−34%**
$1,436 → $1,476	19 W · 33 L	6 hit the 4R target	PF 1.26	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 84%

SOL price with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Down, but choppy. SOL went from $194 to $125 (−34%) with annualised volatility of 84% (its typical month: 96%). Trend efficiency of 0.12 means mostly a round trip — very choppy. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 42% of the time and crossed it 58 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −68%.

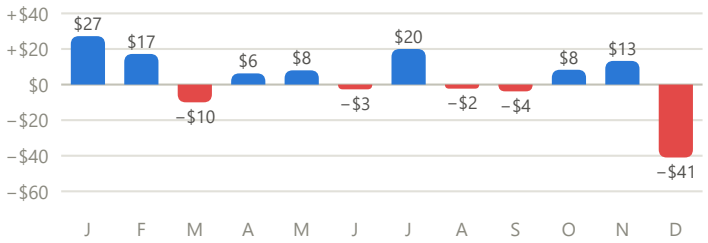
Biggest month up: **Jan** (+22%); biggest month down: **Feb** (−36%).

Backdrop: Described from the price data only.

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Jan	+22%	Drift up	5	2/3	40%	**+$27**	+1.09R	3.20	−$5	1	$1,436	$1,463
Feb	−36%	Trend down	3	2/1	67%	**+$17**	+1.15R	4.33	−$5	1	$1,463	$1,480
Mar	−16%	Choppy	3	1/2	33%	**−$10**	−0.67R	0.01	−$10	1	$1,480	$1,470
Apr	+18%	Drift up	3	2/1	67%	**+$6**	+0.42R	2.23	−$5	1	$1,470	$1,476
May	+6%	Choppy, quiet	5	2/3	40%	**+$8**	+0.32R	1.68	−$12	3	$1,476	$1,484
Jun	−1%	Choppy, quiet	5	2/3	40%	**−$3**	−0.11R	0.83	−$10	2	$1,484	$1,482
Jul	+11%	Drift up, quiet	5	2/3	40%	**+$20**	+0.80R	2.30	−$10	2	$1,482	$1,502
Aug	+17%	Drift up	4	2/2	50%	**−$2**	−0.11R	0.78	−$6	1	$1,502	$1,499
Sep	+4%	Choppy, quiet	4	1/3	25%	**−$4**	−0.19R	0.75	−$10	2	$1,499	$1,496
Oct	−10%	Drift down	5	1/4	20%	**+$8**	+0.33R	1.72	−$10	3	$1,496	$1,504
Nov	−29%	Trend down	2	2/0	100%	**+$13**	+1.33R	∞	$0	0	$1,504	$1,517
Dec	−7%	Choppy	8	0/8	0%	**−$41**	−1.02R	0.00	−$41	8	$1,517	$1,476
Year	−34%		52	19/33	37%	**+$41**	+0.16R	1.26	−$41	8	$1,436	$1,476

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

52 trades, 19 winners (37%), net **+$41** — +0.16R per trade, profit factor 1.26. 7 of 12 trading months were profitable.

Textbook behaviour: the 6 months where SOL moved 15% or more made +$52, and the 4 near-flat months (under 10%) cost −$40. The big moves paid for the chop.

Best month **Jan** (+$27); worst **Dec** (−$41). Longest losing streak: **8** (1 Dec 2025 → 29 Dec 2025, −$41). Max drawdown −$41.

Longs +$31 · shorts +$10. Exits: 6 targets, 29 stops, 17 time exits (averaging +0.83R).

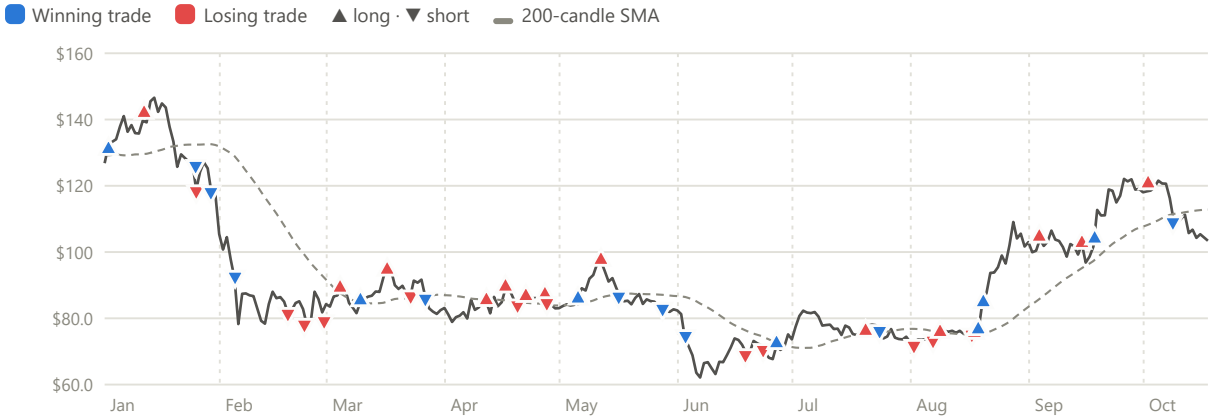
SOLANA (SOL)

2026 (to mid-October)

Sideways / choppy · quiet

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
+$56	42	38%	+0.27R	−$38	6	−17%
$1,476 → $1,532	16 W · 26 L	6 hit the 4R target	PF 1.42	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 60%

SOL price with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Sideways / choppy · quiet. SOL went from $127 to $103 (−17%) with annualised volatility of 60% (its typical month: 96%). Trend efficiency of 0.09 means mostly a round trip — very choppy. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 51% of the time and crossed it 70 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −60%.

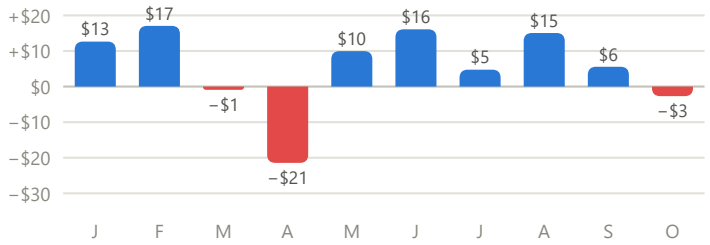
Biggest month up: **Aug** (+41%); biggest month down: **Feb** (−20%).

Backdrop: Described from the price data only (to mid-October).

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Jan	−15%	Drift down, quiet	4	2/2	50%	+$13	+0.63R	2.22	−$5	1	$1,476	$1,489
Feb	−20%	Drift down	4	2/2	50%	+$17	+0.85R	2.66	−$10	2	$1,489	$1,506
Mar	−1%	Choppy, quiet	5	1/4	20%	−$1	−0.04R	0.96	−$10	2	$1,506	$1,505
Apr	−0%	Choppy, quiet	6	1/5	17%	−$21	−0.71R	0.18	−$26	5	$1,505	$1,484
May	−1%	Choppy, quiet	4	2/2	50%	+$10	+0.50R	1.97	−$5	1	$1,484	$1,493
Jun	−11%	Choppy	4	2/2	50%	+$16	+0.80R	2.56	−$10	2	$1,493	$1,510
Jul	−1%	Choppy, quiet	2	1/1	50%	+$5	+0.47R	1.88	−$5	1	$1,510	$1,514
Aug	+41%	Trend up, quiet	8	3/5	38%	+$15	+0.38R	1.61	−$24	5	$1,514	$1,529
Sep	+15%	Drift up, quiet	3	1/2	33%	+$6	+0.37R	1.53	−$11	2	$1,529	$1,535
Oct	−12%	Trend down, quiet	2	1/1	50%	−$3	−0.27R	0.49	−$5	1	$1,535	$1,532
Year	−17%		42	16/26	38%	+$56	+0.27R	1.42	−$38	6	$1,476	$1,532

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

42 trades, 16 winners (38%), net **+$56** — +0.27R per trade, profit factor 1.42. 7 of 10 trading months were profitable.

Textbook behaviour: the 3 months where SOL moved 15% or more made +$45, and the 4 near-flat months (under 10%) cost −$8. The big moves paid for the chop.

Best month **Feb** (+$17); worst **Apr** (−$21). Longest losing streak: **6** (11 Apr 2026 → 5 May 2026, −$31). Max drawdown −$38.

Longs +$30 · shorts +$26. Exits: 6 targets, 25 stops, 11 time exits (averaging +1.26R).

3 · Zcash (ZEC) — six-year overview

NET PROFIT	TRADES / WIN RATE	AVERAGE TRADE	PROFIT FACTOR	MAX DRAWDOWN	LONGEST LOSING STREAK
+$592	**332 · 39%**	**+0.36R**	**1.60**	**−$78**	**9 trades**
+59% on $1,000	131 wins, 201 losses	win +2.41R · loss −0.98R	gross profit ÷ gross loss	6% of peak equity	8 streaks of 5+

Price (log scale, daily close) and the 200-candle SMA



Account equity ($1,000 start) and drawdown



Year by year

Year	Trades	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start	End	Coin	Market regime
2020	42	33%	**+$80**	+0.38R	1.64	−$27	5	$1,000	$1,080	−3%	Sideways / choppy
2021	46	48%	**+$190**	+0.82R	2.58	−$15	3	$1,080	$1,270	+129%	Up, but choppy · high volatility
2022	49	41%	**+$17**	+0.07R	1.12	−$37	6	$1,270	$1,288	−75%	Down, but choppy
2023	52	33%	**+$4**	+0.02R	1.02	−$43	9	$1,288	$1,292	−28%	Down, but choppy · quiet
2024	51	41%	**+$128**	+0.50R	1.89	−$28	4	$1,292	$1,419	+109%	Up, but choppy
2025	49	41%	**+$127**	+0.52R	1.88	−$31	5	$1,419	$1,546	+810%	Strong uptrend · high volatility
2026*	43	40%	**+$45**	+0.21R	1.34	−$40	7	$1,546	$1,592	+124%	Up, but choppy
All	332	39%	**+$592**	+0.36R	1.60	−$78	9	$1,000	$1,592		

Deepest drawdowns

Peak → trough	Depth	Recovered
2022-10-13 → 2023-02-22	−$78	2023-07-02 (262 d)
2026-05-27 → 2026-08-17	−$40	2026-09-23 (119 d)
2023-08-01 → 2023-11-30	−$36	2024-06-18 (321 d)

Longest losing streaks

Losses	From → to	Cost
9	2022-12-27 → 2023-02-24	−$43
7	2026-09-23 → 2026-10-19	−$36
6	2022-10-13 → 2022-11-08	−$31

Best months

Month	Net	Coin	Regime
Feb 2021	+$43	+30%	Choppy, high vol
May 2026	+$42	+62%	Drift up
Oct 2025	+$41	+444%	Trend up, high vol
May 2023	+$36	−14%	Drift down, quiet

Worst months

Month	Net	Coin	Regime
Nov 2023	−$26	+4%	Choppy, quiet
Oct 2026	−$25	−20%	Drift down
Apr 2022	−$23	−36%	Trend down
Jan 2023	−$22	+21%	Drift up, quiet

*2026 to mid-October. 55 of 81 months profitable. Regime labels are measured from the candles: trend efficiency = net move ÷ distance travelled (1 = straight line).

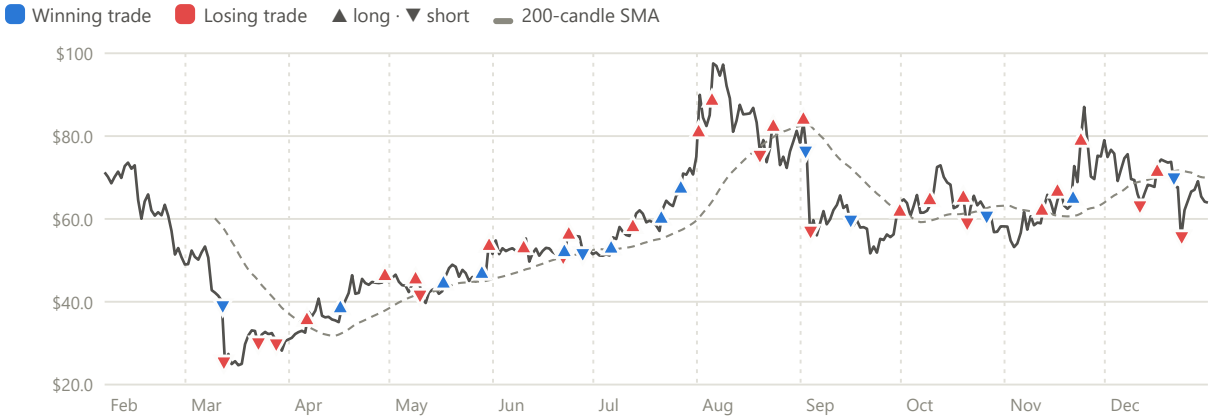
ZCASH (ZEC)

2020 (from listing in February)

Sideways / choppy

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
+$80	42	33%	+0.38R	−$27	5	−3%
$1,000 → $1,080	14 W · 28 L	9 hit the 4R target	PF 1.64	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 109%

ZEC price with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Sideways / choppy. ZEC went from $71.2 to $63.9 (−3%) with annualised volatility of 109% (its typical month: 102%). Trend efficiency of 0.02 means mostly a round trip — very choppy. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 56% of the time and crossed it 58 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −60%.

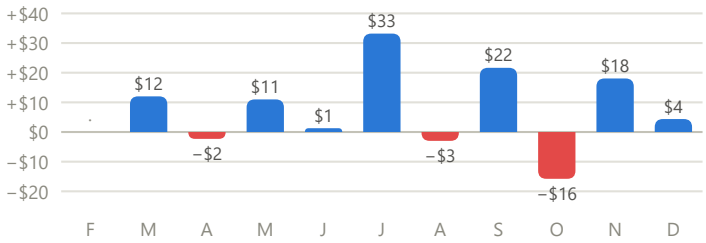
Biggest month up: **Jul** (+46%); biggest month down: **Mar** (−37%).

Backdrop: COVID crash in March (BTC fell ~50% in two days), the May halving, then an institution-led rally from October into year-end.

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Feb	−26%	Trend down	·			·					$1,000	$1,000
Mar	−37%	Drift down, high vol	3	1/2	33%	+$12	+0.80R	2.57	−$8	2	$1,000	$1,012
Apr	+45%	Drift up	4	1/3	25%	−$2	−0.12R	0.80	−$6	2	$1,012	$1,010
May	+15%	Choppy	4	2/2	50%	+$11	+0.55R	2.06	−$10	2	$1,010	$1,021
Jun	−0%	Choppy, quiet	5	1/4	20%	+$1	+0.05R	1.07	−$12	3	$1,021	$1,022
Jul	+46%	Trend up, quiet	4	3/1	75%	+$33	+1.66R	9.12	−$4	1	$1,022	$1,055
Aug	+4%	Choppy	5	1/4	20%	−$3	−0.12R	0.86	−$22	4	$1,055	$1,052
Sep	−18%	Drift down	4	2/2	50%	+$22	+1.08R	4.08	−$5	1	$1,052	$1,074
Oct	−9%	Choppy	4	0/4	0%	−$16	−0.79R	0.00	−$16	4	$1,074	$1,058
Nov	+36%	Drift up	5	2/3	40%	+$18	+0.72R	2.15	−$10	2	$1,058	$1,076
Dec	−19%	Choppy	4	1/3	25%	+$4	+0.22R	1.28	−$11	2	$1,076	$1,080
Year	−3%		42	14/28	33%	+$80	+0.38R	1.64	−$27	5	$1,000	$1,080

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

42 trades, 14 winners (33%), net **+$80** — +0.38R per trade, profit factor 1.64. 7 of 10 trading months were profitable.

Textbook behaviour: the 8 months where ZEC moved 15% or more made +$98, and the 3 near-flat months (under 10%) cost −$17. The big moves paid for the chop.

Best month **Jul** (+$33); worst **Oct** (−$16). Longest losing streak: **5** (1 Aug 2020 → 2 Sep 2020, −$27). Max drawdown −$27.

Longs +$42 · shorts +$38. Exits: 9 targets, 22 stops, 11 time exits (averaging +0.42R).

ZCASH (ZEC)

2021

Up, but choppy · high volatility

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
+$190	**46**	**48%**	**+0.82R**	**−$15**	**3**	**+129%**
$1,080 → $1,270	22 W · 24 L	14 hit the 4R target	PF 2.58	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 151%

ZEC price (log scale) with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Up, but choppy · high volatility. ZEC went from $56.6 to $146 (+129%) with annualised volatility of 151% (its typical month: 102%). Trend efficiency of 0.09 means mostly a round trip — very choppy. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 56% of the time and crossed it 60 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −78%.

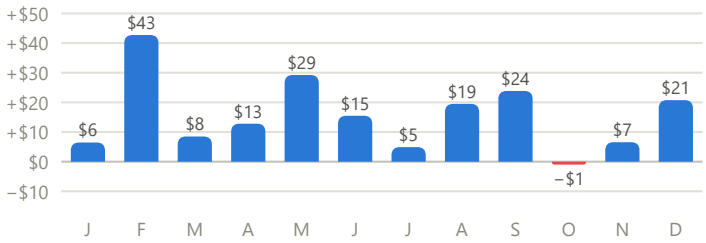
Biggest month up: **Oct** (+56%); biggest month down: **May** (−34%).

Backdrop: Bull-market peak year: a run to April highs, a violent May crash (leverage flush, China mining ban), a summer range, a new BTC high in November, then decline. Altcoins (SOL especially) went parabolic.

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Jan	+34%	Drift up, high vol	5	2/3	40%	**+$6**	+0.26R	1.43	−$10	2	$1,080	$1,087
Feb	+30%	Choppy, high vol	3	3/0	100%	**+$43**	+2.85R	∞	$0	0	$1,087	$1,130
Mar	+42%	Drift up	3	1/2	33%	**+$8**	+0.57R	1.81	−$11	2	$1,130	$1,138
Apr	+55%	Drift up, high vol	2	1/1	50%	**+$13**	+1.28R	3.15	−$6	1	$1,138	$1,151
May	−34%	Drift down, high vol	5	3/2	60%	**+$29**	+1.17R	3.59	−$6	1	$1,151	$1,180
Jun	−19%	Choppy, high vol	3	2/1	67%	**+$15**	+1.03R	4.10	−$5	1	$1,180	$1,196
Jul	−15%	Choppy	4	1/3	25%	**+$5**	+0.25R	1.32	−$10	2	$1,196	$1,201
Aug	+29%	Drift up	4	2/2	50%	**+$19**	+0.97R	2.87	−$10	2	$1,201	$1,220
Sep	−26%	Drift down	4	2/2	50%	**+$24**	+1.19R	5.40	−$5	2	$1,220	$1,244
Oct	+56%	Trend up	5	1/4	20%	**−$1**	−0.04R	0.95	−$15	3	$1,244	$1,243
Nov	+32%	Choppy, high vol	5	2/3	40%	**+$7**	+0.26R	1.42	−$10	2	$1,243	$1,249
Dec	−34%	Trend down	3	2/1	67%	**+$21**	+1.38R	5.13	−$5	1	$1,249	$1,270
Year	+129%		46	22/24	48%	**+$190**	+0.82R	2.58	−$15	3	$1,080	$1,270

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

46 trades, 22 winners (48%), net **+$190** — +0.82R per trade, profit factor 2.58. 11 of 12 trading months were profitable.

Every month moved at least 10%, and the 12 months with a 15%+ move made +$190 — plenty of movement for a breakout strategy.

Best month **Feb** (+$43); worst **Oct** (−$1). Longest losing streak: **3** (28 Sep 2021 → 15 Oct 2021, −$15). Max drawdown −$15.

Longs +$147 · shorts +$42. Exits: 14 targets, 23 stops, 9 time exits (averaging +0.90R).

ZCASH (ZEC)

2022

Down, but choppy

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
+$17	**49**	**41%**	**+0.07R**	**−$37**	**6**	**−75%**
$1,270 → $1,288	20 W · 29 L	4 hit the 4R target	PF 1.12	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 102%

ZEC price (log scale) with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Down, but choppy. ZEC went from $150 to $37.3 (−75%) with annualised volatility of 102% (its typical month: 102%). Trend efficiency of 0.22 means a lot of back-and-forth for the distance covered. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 29% of the time and crossed it 62 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −85%.

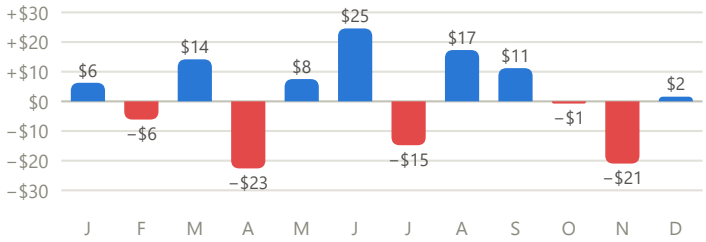
Biggest month up: **Mar** (+50%); biggest month down: **Jun** (−42%).

Backdrop: Bear market: aggressive Fed rate hikes, the LUNA/UST collapse in May, Celsius/3AC in June, and the FTX collapse in November — which hit SOL hardest because FTX/Alameda were major backers.

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Jan	−36%	Trend down	5	2/3	40%	**+$6**	+0.25R	1.41	−$15	3	$1,270	$1,276
Feb	+26%	Choppy	3	1/2	33%	**−$6**	−0.41R	0.09	−$7	2	$1,276	$1,270
Mar	+50%	Drift up	3	2/1	67%	**+$14**	+0.95R	3.76	−$5	1	$1,270	$1,284
Apr	−36%	Trend down	5	0/5	0%	**−$23**	−0.90R	0.00	−$23	5	$1,284	$1,262
May	−18%	Drift down, high vol	2	2/0	100%	**+$8**	+0.75R	∞	$0	0	$1,262	$1,269
Jun	−42%	Trend down	4	3/1	75%	**+$25**	+1.23R	5.89	−$5	1	$1,269	$1,294
Jul	+18%	Drift up	5	1/4	20%	**−$15**	−0.59R	0.28	−$21	4	$1,294	$1,279
Aug	−7%	Choppy	3	3/0	100%	**+$17**	+1.15R	∞	$0	0	$1,279	$1,297
Sep	−7%	Choppy, quiet	5	2/3	40%	**+$11**	+0.45R	1.73	−$10	2	$1,297	$1,308
Oct	−6%	Choppy, quiet	5	1/4	20%	**−$1**	−0.03R	0.96	−$16	3	$1,308	$1,307
Nov	−18%	Choppy	7	1/6	14%	**−$21**	−0.60R	0.32	−$21	3	$1,307	$1,286
Dec	−14%	Drift down, quiet	2	2/0	100%	**+$2**	+0.16R	∞	$0	0	$1,286	$1,288
Year	−75%		49	20/29	41%	**+$17**	+0.07R	1.12	−$37	6	$1,270	$1,288

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

49 trades, 20 winners (41%), net **+$17** — +0.07R per trade, profit factor 1.12. 7 of 12 trading months were profitable.

A good year even in quiet months: the 8 big-move months made −$12 and the 3 near-flat months still added +$28.

Best month **Jun** (+$25); worst **Apr** (−$23). Longest losing streak: **6** (13 Oct 2022 → 8 Nov 2022, −$31). Max drawdown −$37.

Longs −$8 · shorts +$25. Exits: 4 targets, 27 stops, 18 time exits (averaging +0.85R).

ZCASH (ZEC)

2023

Down, but choppy · quiet

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
+$4	**52**	**33%**	**+0.02R**	**−$43**	**9**	**−28%**
$1,288 → $1,292	17 W · 35 L	6 hit the 4R target	PF 1.02	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 68%

ZEC price with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Down, but choppy · quiet. ZEC went from $37.2 to $26.9 (−28%) with annualised volatility of 68% (its typical month: 102%). Trend efficiency of 0.09 means mostly a round trip — very choppy. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 46% of the time and crossed it 100 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −58%.

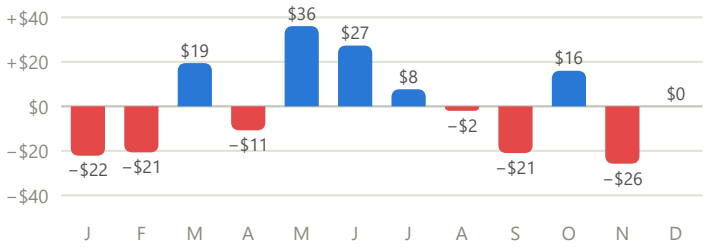
Biggest month up: **Jan** (+21%); biggest month down: **Aug** (−18%).

Backdrop: Recovery: March banking stress, then a grinding rally, accelerating in Oct–Dec on spot-ETF expectations. SOL rebounded from its post-FTX low.

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Jan	+21%	Drift up, quiet	5	0/5	0%	**−$22**	−0.89R	0.00	−$22	5	$1,288	$1,265
Feb	−5%	Choppy	4	0/4	0%	**−$21**	−1.03R	0.00	−$21	4	$1,265	$1,245
Mar	−10%	Choppy	4	2/2	50%	**+$19**	+0.97R	2.90	−$10	2	$1,245	$1,264
Apr	−3%	Choppy, quiet	5	1/4	20%	**−$11**	−0.43R	0.48	−$11	2	$1,264	$1,253
May	−14%	Drift down, quiet	4	3/1	75%	**+$36**	+1.80R	7.85	−$5	1	$1,253	$1,289
Jun	+5%	Choppy	2	2/0	100%	**+$27**	+2.73R	∞	$0	0	$1,289	$1,317
Jul	−10%	Drift down, quiet	3	2/1	67%	**+$8**	+0.51R	2.54	−$5	1	$1,317	$1,324
Aug	−18%	Trend down, quiet	4	2/2	50%	**−$2**	−0.10R	0.81	−$11	2	$1,324	$1,322
Sep	+9%	Drift up, quiet	4	0/4	0%	**−$21**	−1.05R	0.00	−$21	4	$1,322	$1,301
Oct	+5%	Choppy, quiet	6	3/3	50%	**+$16**	+0.53R	2.02	−$7	1	$1,301	$1,317
Nov	+4%	Choppy, quiet	5	0/5	0%	**−$26**	−1.03R	0.00	−$26	5	$1,317	$1,292
Dec	−9%	Choppy, quiet	6	2/4	33%	**$0**	+0.01R	1.01	−$19	3	$1,292	$1,292
Year	−28%		52	17/35	33%	**+$4**	+0.02R	1.02	−$43	9	$1,288	$1,292

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

52 trades, 17 winners (33%), net **+$4** — +0.02R per trade, profit factor 1.02. 6 of 12 trading months were profitable.

Profitable even though the big-move months netted −$24 — the gains came from moderate trending months; near-flat months made −$35.

Best month **May** (+$36); worst **Nov** (−$26). Longest losing streak: **9** (27 Dec 2022 → 22 Feb 2023, −$43). Max drawdown −$43.

Longs −$38 · shorts +$42. Exits: 6 targets, 34 stops, 12 time exits (averaging +1.07R).

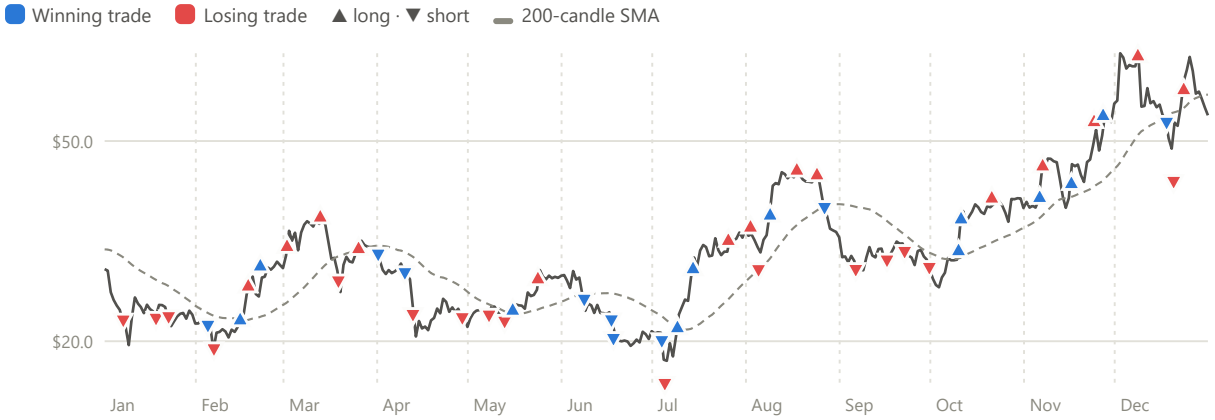
ZCASH (ZEC)

2024

Up, but choppy

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
+$128	**51**	**41%**	**+0.50R**	**−$28**	**4**	**+109%**
$1,292 → $1,419	21 W · 30 L	10 hit the 4R target	PF 1.89	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 106%

ZEC price (log scale) with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Up, but choppy. ZEC went from $27.8 to $56.3 (+109%) with annualised volatility of 106% (its typical month: 102%). Trend efficiency of 0.24 means a lot of back-and-forth for the distance covered. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 50% of the time and crossed it 42 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −56%.

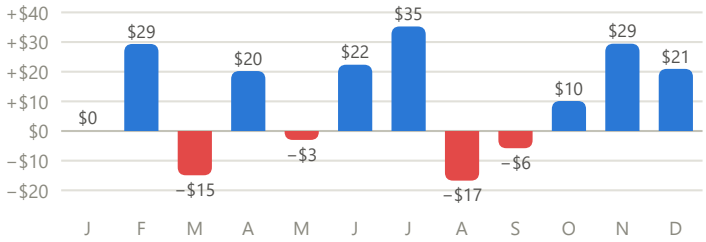
Biggest month up: **Nov** (+61%); biggest month down: **Apr** (−30%).

Backdrop: US spot BTC ETFs launched in January; BTC made a new high in March, halved in April, ranged through the summer (sharp August sell-off), then rallied on the November US election.

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Jan	−19%	Drift down	4	1/3	25%	**$0**	+0.01R	1.02	−$12	3	$1,292	$1,292
Feb	+29%	Drift up	4	2/2	50%	**+$29**	+1.47R	3.92	−$5	1	$1,292	$1,322
Mar	+9%	Choppy	4	1/3	25%	**−$15**	−0.75R	0.06	−$16	3	$1,322	$1,307
Apr	−30%	Trend down	4	2/2	50%	**+$20**	+1.01R	4.00	−$6	1	$1,307	$1,327
May	+26%	Trend up, quiet	4	1/3	25%	**−$3**	−0.15R	0.80	−$15	3	$1,327	$1,324
Jun	−22%	Trend down, quiet	4	3/1	75%	**+$22**	+1.12R	20.81	−$1	1	$1,324	$1,346
Jul	+60%	Trend up	5	3/2	60%	**+$35**	+1.41R	4.45	−$5	1	$1,346	$1,381
Aug	−4%	Choppy	6	1/5	17%	**−$17**	−0.56R	0.35	−$17	3	$1,381	$1,365
Sep	−14%	Choppy, quiet	4	1/3	25%	**−$6**	−0.29R	0.62	−$15	3	$1,365	$1,359
Oct	+33%	Trend up	4	2/2	50%	**+$10**	+0.51R	1.99	−$5	1	$1,359	$1,369
Nov	+61%	Trend up, high vol	4	2/2	50%	**+$29**	+1.47R	3.88	−$5	1	$1,369	$1,398
Dec	−5%	Choppy, high vol	4	2/2	50%	**+$21**	+1.05R	3.05	−$5	1	$1,398	$1,419
Year	+109%		51	21/30	41%	**+$128**	+0.50R	1.89	−$28	4	$1,292	$1,419

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

51 trades, 21 winners (41%), net **+$128** — +0.50R per trade, profit factor 1.89. 8 of 12 trading months were profitable.

Textbook behaviour: the 8 months where ZEC moved 15% or more made +$144, and the 3 near-flat months (under 10%) cost −$11. The big moves paid for the chop.

Best month **Jul** (+$35); worst **Aug** (−$17). Longest losing streak: **4** (2 Mar 2024 → 1 Apr 2024, −$22). Max drawdown −$28.

Longs +$74 · shorts +$53. Exits: 10 targets, 27 stops, 14 time exits (averaging +0.98R).

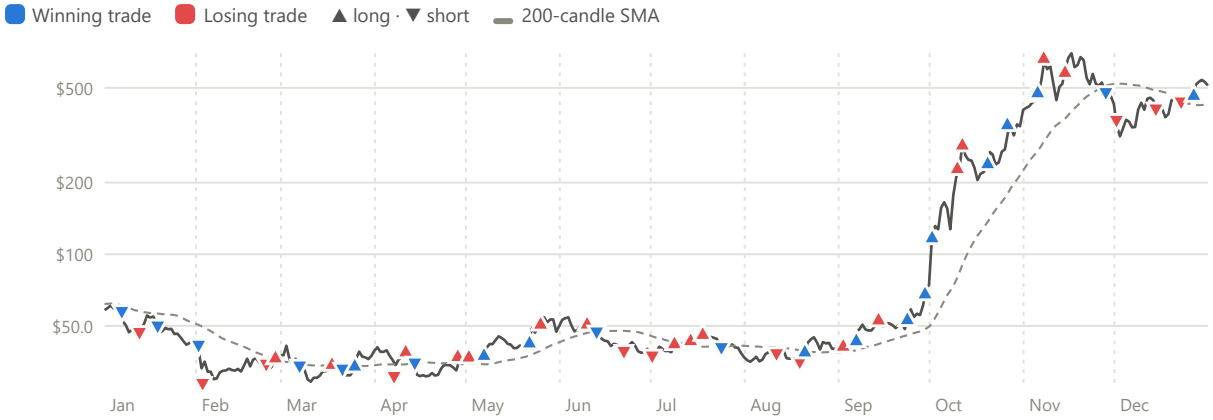
ZCASH (ZEC)

2025

Strong uptrend · high volatility

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
+$127	**49**	**41%**	**+0.52R**	**−$31**	**5**	**+810%**
$1,419 → $1,546	20 W · 29 L	10 hit the 4R target	PF 1.88	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 139%

ZEC price (log scale) with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Strong uptrend · high volatility. ZEC went from $58.2 to $512 (+810%) with annualised volatility of 139% (its typical month: 102%). Trend efficiency of 0.34 means a fairly directional path. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 53% of the time and crossed it 45 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −61%.

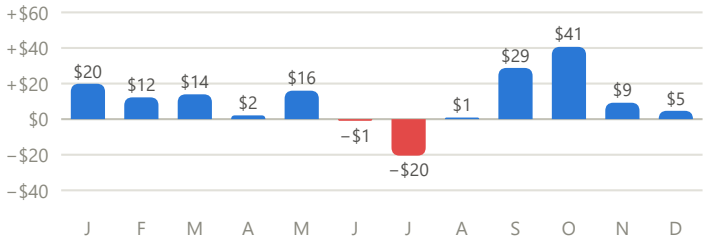
Biggest month up: **Oct** (+444%); biggest month down: **Jun** (−24%).

Backdrop: Described from the price data only.

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Jan	−23%	Drift down	4	2/2	50%	**+$20**	+0.99R	2.93	−$5	1	$1,419	$1,439
Feb	−13%	Choppy	3	1/2	33%	**+$12**	+0.82R	2.60	−$8	2	$1,439	$1,452
Mar	+5%	Choppy	4	2/2	50%	**+$14**	+0.70R	2.36	−$5	1	$1,452	$1,465
Apr	−8%	Choppy	5	2/3	40%	**+$2**	+0.08R	1.14	−$10	2	$1,465	$1,468
May	+39%	Drift up	4	2/2	50%	**+$16**	+0.80R	2.59	−$5	1	$1,468	$1,484
Jun	−24%	Trend down, quiet	3	1/2	33%	**−$1**	−0.06R	0.91	−$5	1	$1,484	$1,483
Jul	−3%	Choppy	4	0/4	0%	**−$20**	−1.02R	0.00	−$20	4	$1,483	$1,462
Aug	+9%	Choppy	4	2/2	50%	**+$1**	+0.05R	1.09	−$10	2	$1,462	$1,463
Sep	+84%	Trend up	4	2/2	50%	**+$29**	+1.44R	3.77	−$5	1	$1,463	$1,492
Oct	+444%	Trend up, high vol	5	3/2	60%	**+$41**	+1.63R	5.04	−$10	2	$1,492	$1,533
Nov	+6%	Choppy, high vol	5	2/3	40%	**+$9**	+0.37R	1.62	−$10	2	$1,533	$1,542
Dec	+20%	Drift up, high vol	4	1/3	25%	**+$5**	+0.23R	1.31	−$15	3	$1,542	$1,546
Year	+810%		49	20/29	41%	**+$127**	+0.52R	1.88	−$31	5	$1,419	$1,546

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

49 trades, 20 winners (41%), net **+$127** — +0.52R per trade, profit factor 1.88. 10 of 12 trading months were profitable.

A good year even in quiet months: the 6 big-move months made +$109 and the 5 near-flat months still added +$6.

Best month **Oct** (+$41); worst **Jul** (−$20). Longest losing streak: **5** (22 Jun 2025 → 19 Jul 2025, −$26). Max drawdown −$31.

Longs +$65 · shorts +$62. Exits: 10 targets, 28 stops, 11 time exits (averaging +1.28R).

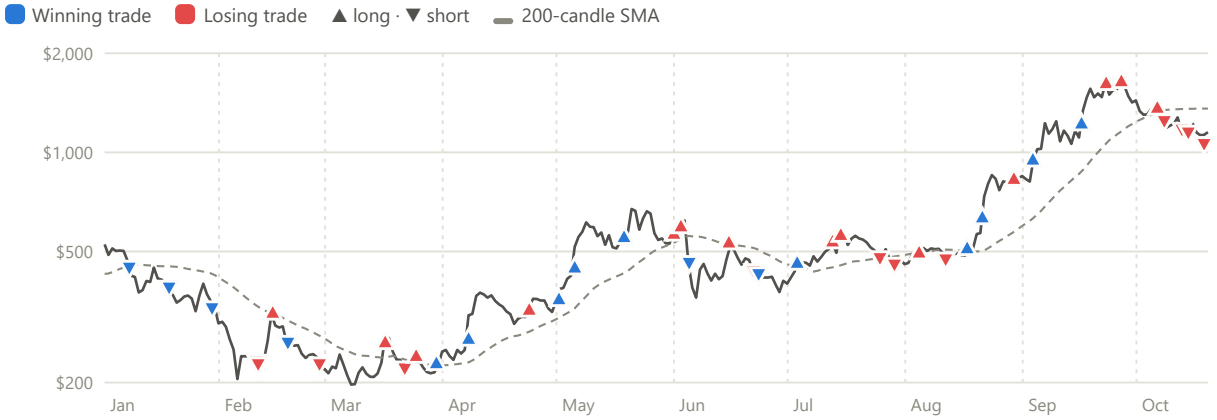
ZCASH (ZEC)

2026 (to mid-October)

Up, but choppy

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
+$45	**43**	**40%**	**+0.21R**	**−$40**	**7**	**+124%**
$1,546 → $1,592	17 W · 26 L	5 hit the 4R target	PF 1.34	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 121%

ZEC price (log scale) with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Up, but choppy. ZEC went from $525 to $1,152 (+124%) with annualised volatility of 121% (its typical month: 102%). Trend efficiency of 0.17 means a lot of back-and-forth for the distance covered. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 54% of the time and crossed it 35 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −66%.

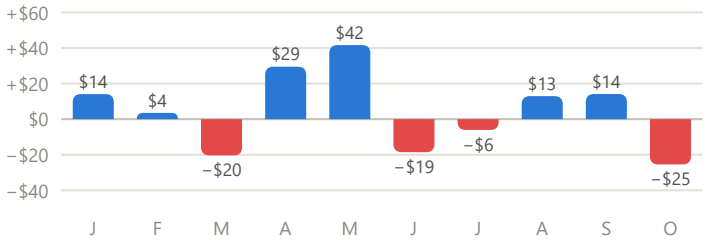
Biggest month up: **Aug** (+85%); biggest month down: **Jan** (−41%).

Backdrop: Described from the price data only (to mid-October).

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Jan	−41%	Trend down	3	3/0	100%	**+$14**	+0.94R	∞	$0	0	$1,546	$1,560
Feb	−27%	Drift down	5	2/3	40%	**+$4**	+0.14R	1.23	−$15	3	$1,560	$1,564
Mar	+13%	Choppy	4	0/4	0%	**−$20**	−1.02R	0.00	−$20	4	$1,564	$1,544
Apr	+41%	Drift up	3	2/1	67%	**+$29**	+1.96R	6.70	−$5	1	$1,544	$1,573
May	+62%	Drift up	3	3/0	100%	**+$42**	+2.77R	∞	$0	0	$1,573	$1,615
Jun	−30%	Drift down, high vol	5	1/4	20%	**−$19**	−0.74R	0.08	−$19	2	$1,615	$1,596
Jul	+15%	Choppy	5	2/3	40%	**−$6**	−0.24R	0.60	−$15	3	$1,596	$1,590
Aug	+85%	Trend up	5	2/3	40%	**+$13**	+0.52R	1.85	−$15	3	$1,590	$1,603
Sep	+70%	Drift up	5	2/3	40%	**+$14**	+0.57R	1.92	−$10	2	$1,603	$1,617
Oct	−20%	Drift down	5	0/5	0%	**−$25**	−1.02R	0.00	−$25	5	$1,617	$1,592
Year	+124%		43	17/26	40%	**+$45**	+0.21R	1.34	−$40	7	$1,546	$1,592

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

43 trades, 17 winners (40%), net **+$45** — +0.21R per trade, profit factor 1.34. 6 of 10 trading months were profitable.

Every month moved at least 10%, and the 8 months with a 15%+ move made +$72 — plenty of movement for a breakout strategy.

Best month **May** (+$42); worst **Oct** (−$25). Longest losing streak: **7** (23 Sep 2026 → 19 Oct 2026, −$36). Max drawdown −$40.

Longs +$73 · shorts −$28. Exits: 5 targets, 26 stops, 12 time exits (averaging +1.31R).

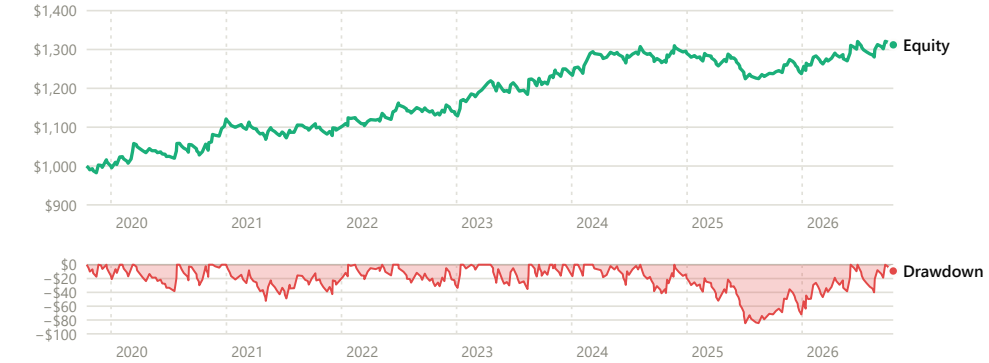
3 · Bitcoin (BTC) — six-year overview

NET PROFIT	TRADES / WIN RATE	AVERAGE TRADE	PROFIT FACTOR	MAX DRAWDOWN	LONGEST LOSING STREAK
+$312	**368 · 35%**	**+0.17R**	**1.26**	**−$85**	**10 trades**
+31% on $1,000	127 wins, 241 losses	win +2.35R · loss −0.98R	gross profit ÷ gross loss	6% of peak equity	12 streaks of 5+

Price (log scale, daily close) and the 200-candle SMA



Account equity ($1,000 start) and drawdown



Year by year

Year	Trades	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start	End	Coin	Market regime
2019	12	25%	**$0**	+0.01R	1.01	−$17	3	$1,000	$1,000	−30%	Downtrend
2020	53	42%	**+$121**	+0.46R	1.81	−$38	6	$1,000	$1,121	+303%	Strong uptrend · high volatility
2021	51	29%	**−$29**	−0.11R	0.84	−$52	6	$1,121	$1,092	+60%	Up, but choppy · high volatility
2022	48	35%	**+$41**	+0.17R	1.29	−$31	6	$1,092	$1,134	−64%	Strong downtrend · high volatility
2023	56	39%	**+$105**	+0.38R	1.61	−$35	5	$1,134	$1,239	+156%	Strong uptrend
2024	53	38%	**+$51**	+0.19R	1.30	−$42	5	$1,239	$1,290	+121%	Uptrend
2025	52	25%	**−$53**	−0.20R	0.72	−$66	10	$1,290	$1,238	−6%	Sideways / choppy
2026*	43	35%	**+$74**	+0.35R	1.54	−$40	8	$1,238	$1,312	−7%	Sideways / choppy
All	368	35%	**+$312**	+0.17R	1.26	−$85	10	$1,000	$1,312		

Deepest drawdowns

Peak → trough	Depth	Recovered
2024-11-21 → 2025-07-04	−$85	2026-06-04 (560 d)
2020-12-31 → 2021-05-05	−$52	2022-01-22 (387 d)
2024-08-05 → 2024-10-11	−$42	2024-11-21 (108 d)

Longest losing streaks

Losses	From → to	Cost
10	2025-06-03 → 2025-07-09	−$54
8	2026-06-30 → 2026-08-17	−$40
7	2025-02-25 → 2025-04-21	−$33

Best months

Month	Net	Coin	Regime
Jun 2026	+$50	−20%	Trend down
Mar 2020	+$43	−25%	Drift down, high vol
Dec 2020	+$42	+47%	Trend up, high vol
Feb 2024	+$40	+44%	Trend up

Worst months

Month	Net	Coin	Regime
Jun 2025	−$43	+2%	Choppy, quiet
Dec 2025	−$36	−3%	Choppy
Jul 2026	−$27	+7%	Choppy, quiet
Dec 2022	−$24	−4%	Choppy, quiet

*2026 to mid-October. 46 of 86 months profitable. Regime labels are measured from the candles: trend efficiency = net move ÷ distance travelled (1 = straight line).

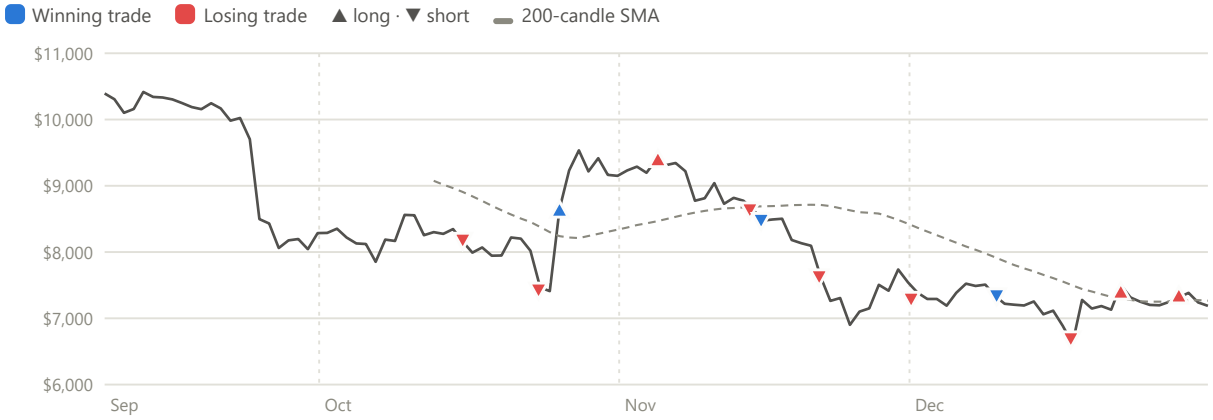
BITCOIN (BTC)

2019 (Sep–Dec only)

Downtrend

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
$0	**12**	**25%**	**+0.01R**	**−$17**	**3**	**−30%**
$1,000 → $1,000	3 W · 9 L	2 hit the 4R target	PF 1.01	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 61%

BTC price with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Downtrend. BTC went from $10,392 to $7,189 (−30%) with annualised volatility of 61% (its typical month: 49%). Trend efficiency of 0.36 means a fairly directional path. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 21% of the time and crossed it 10 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −38%.

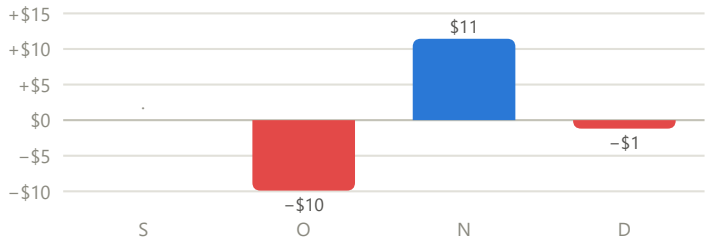
Biggest month up: **Oct** (+10%); biggest month down: **Sep** (−20%).

Backdrop: BTC slid from about $10k to $7k after the mid-2019 rally (only Sep–Dec is in the data).

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Sep	−20%	Trend down, high vol	·			·					$1,000	$1,000
Oct	+10%	Choppy, high vol	2	0/2	0%	**−$10**	−0.99R	0.00	−$10	2	$1,000	$990
Nov	−18%	Trend down	5	2/3	40%	**+$11**	+0.46R	1.97	−$11	2	$990	$1,002
Dec	−5%	Choppy	5	1/4	20%	**−$1**	−0.05R	0.94	−$16	3	$1,002	$1,000
Year	−30%		12	3/9	25%	**$0**	+0.01R	1.01	−$17	3	$1,000	$1,000

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

12 trades, 3 winners (25%), net **$0** — +0.01R per trade, profit factor 1.01. 1 of 3 trading months were profitable.

Textbook behaviour: the 2 months where BTC moved 15% or more made +$11, and the 1 near-flat month (under 10%) cost −$1. The big moves paid for the chop.

Best month **Nov** (+$11); worst **Oct** (−$10). Longest losing streak: **3** (17 Dec 2019 → 30 Dec 2019, −$16). Max drawdown −$17.

Longs −$13 · shorts +$13. Exits: 2 targets, 8 stops, 2 time exits (averaging +0.21R).

BITCOIN (BTC)

2020

Strong uptrend · high volatility

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
+$121	**53**	**42%**	**+0.46R**	**−$38**	**6**	**+303%**
$1,000 → $1,121	22 W · 31 L	11 hit the 4R target	PF 1.81	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 69%

BTC price (log scale) with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Strong uptrend · high volatility. BTC went from $7,198 to $28,952 (+303%) with annualised volatility of 69% (its typical month: 49%). Trend efficiency of 0.51 means a clean, persistent trend. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 70% of the time and crossed it 61 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −66%.

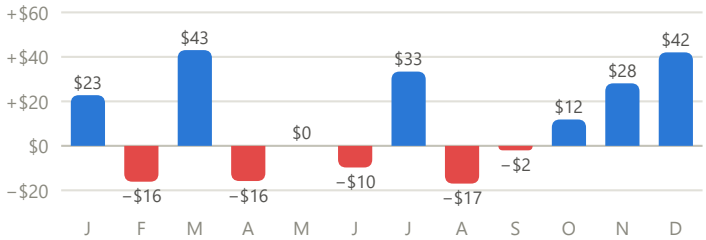
Biggest month up: **Dec** (+47%); biggest month down: **Mar** (−25%).

Backdrop: COVID crash in March (BTC fell ~50% in two days), the May halving, then an institution-led rally from October into year-end.

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Jan	+30%	Trend up	4	2/2	50%	**+$23**	+1.14R	3.11	−$6	1	$1,000	$1,023
Feb	−9%	Drift down	4	1/3	25%	**−$16**	−0.81R	0.05	−$17	3	$1,023	$1,007
Mar	−25%	Drift down, high vol	5	3/2	60%	**+$43**	+1.72R	6.37	−$8	2	$1,007	$1,050
Apr	+35%	Trend up, high vol	3	0/3	0%	**−$16**	−1.05R	0.00	−$16	3	$1,050	$1,034
May	+10%	Choppy, high vol	4	2/2	50%	**$0**	+0.01R	1.02	−$10	1	$1,034	$1,034
Jun	−3%	Range	4	1/3	25%	**−$10**	−0.49R	0.16	−$12	3	$1,034	$1,025
Jul	+24%	Trend up, quiet	4	3/1	75%	**+$33**	+1.67R	7.56	−$5	1	$1,025	$1,058
Aug	+3%	Choppy	4	1/3	25%	**−$17**	−0.85R	0.01	−$17	3	$1,058	$1,041
Sep	−8%	Drift down	6	1/5	17%	**−$2**	−0.07R	0.91	−$16	4	$1,041	$1,039
Oct	+28%	Trend up	5	2/3	40%	**+$12**	+0.47R	1.75	−$11	2	$1,039	$1,051
Nov	+43%	Trend up, high vol	6	3/3	50%	**+$28**	+0.94R	3.22	−$10	2	$1,051	$1,079
Dec	+47%	Trend up, high vol	4	3/1	75%	**+$42**	+2.10R	22.16	−$2	1	$1,079	$1,121
Year	+303%		53	22/31	42%	**+$121**	+0.46R	1.81	−$38	6	$1,000	$1,121

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

53 trades, 22 winners (42%), net **+$121** — +0.46R per trade, profit factor 1.81. 7 of 12 trading months were profitable.

Textbook behaviour: the 7 months where BTC moved 15% or more made +$165, and the 5 near-flat months (under 10%) cost −$45. The big moves paid for the chop.

Best month **Mar** (+$43); worst **Aug** (−$17). Longest losing streak: **6** (4 Sep 2020 → 6 Oct 2020, −$27). Max drawdown −$38.

Longs +$95 · shorts +$26. Exits: 11 targets, 26 stops, 16 time exits (averaging +0.58R).

BITCOIN (BTC)

2021

Up, but choppy · high volatility

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
−$29	**51**	**29%**	**−0.11R**	**−$52**	**6**	**+60%**
$1,121 → $1,092	15 W · 36 L	4 hit the 4R target	PF 0.84	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 87%

BTC price with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Up, but choppy · high volatility. BTC went from $29,337 to $46,211 (+60%) with annualised volatility of 87% (its typical month: 49%). Trend efficiency of 0.09 means mostly a round trip — very choppy. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 55% of the time and crossed it 69 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −56%.

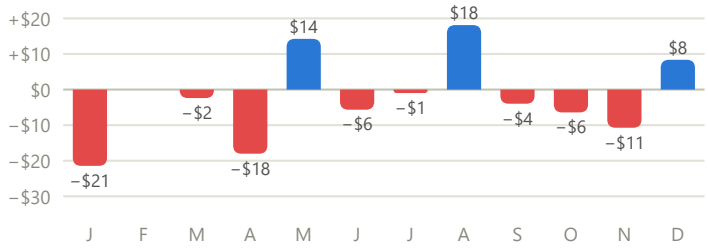
Biggest month up: **Oct** (+40%); biggest month down: **May** (−35%).

Backdrop: Bull-market peak year: a run to April highs, a violent May crash (leverage flush, China mining ban), a summer range, a new BTC high in November, then decline. Altcoins (SOL especially) went parabolic.

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Jan	+14%	Choppy, high vol	4	0/4	0%	−$21	−1.07R	0.00	−$21	4	$1,121	$1,100
Feb	+36%	Drift up, high vol	3	2/1	67%	**$0**	−0.00R	1.00	−$7	1	$1,100	$1,100
Mar	+30%	Drift up, high vol	5	1/4	20%	−$2	−0.10R	0.89	−$16	3	$1,100	$1,097
Apr	−2%	Choppy, high vol	5	1/4	20%	−$18	−0.72R	0.08	−$18	3	$1,097	$1,079
May	−35%	Trend down, high vol	5	2/3	40%	+$14	+0.57R	1.92	−$10	2	$1,079	$1,093
Jun	−6%	Choppy, high vol	4	1/3	25%	−$6	−0.28R	0.63	−$15	3	$1,093	$1,088
Jul	+18%	Trend up, high vol	5	1/4	20%	−$1	−0.04R	0.95	−$15	3	$1,088	$1,087
Aug	+14%	Drift up	3	2/1	67%	+$18	+1.21R	32.01	−$1	1	$1,087	$1,105
Sep	−7%	Choppy, high vol	4	1/3	25%	−$4	−0.20R	0.69	−$13	3	$1,105	$1,101
Oct	+40%	Drift up, high vol	5	2/3	40%	−$6	−0.26R	0.60	−$14	2	$1,101	$1,095
Nov	−7%	Choppy	4	1/3	25%	−$11	−0.54R	0.38	−$12	2	$1,095	$1,084
Dec	−19%	Trend down, high vol	4	1/3	25%	+$8	+0.42R	1.73	−$6	2	$1,084	$1,092
Year	+60%		51	15/36	29%	−$29	−0.11R	0.84	−$52	6	$1,121	$1,092

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

51 trades, 15 winners (29%), net **−$29** — −0.11R per trade, profit factor 0.84. 3 of 12 trading months were profitable.

The year never produced enough clean follow-through: big-move months made +$13, but the 4 near-flat months cost −$38. Breakouts kept reversing back into the range.

Best month **Aug** (+$18); worst **Jan** (−$21). Longest losing streak: **6** (13 Mar 2021 → 18 Apr 2021, −$30). Max drawdown −$52.

Longs −$51 · shorts +$22. Exits: 4 targets, 32 stops, 15 time exits (averaging +0.88R).

BITCOIN (BTC)

2022

Strong downtrend · high volatility

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
+$41	**48**	**35%**	**+0.17R**	**−$31**	**6**	**−64%**
$1,092 → $1,134	17 W · 31 L	5 hit the 4R target	PF 1.29	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 61%

BTC price with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Strong downtrend · high volatility. BTC went from $47,704 to $16,538 (−64%) with annualised volatility of 61% (its typical month: 49%). Trend efficiency of 0.35 means a fairly directional path. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 31% of the time and crossed it 64 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −68%.

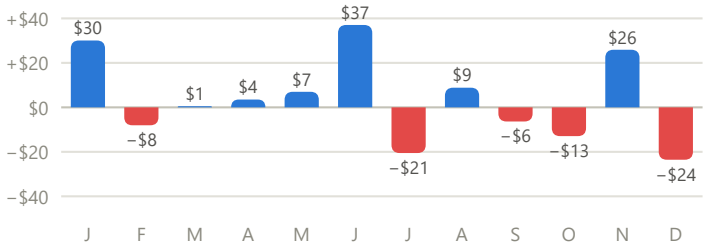
Biggest month up: **Jul** (+17%); biggest month down: **Jun** (−37%).

Backdrop: Bear market: aggressive Fed rate hikes, the LUNA/UST collapse in May, Celsius/3AC in June, and the FTX collapse in November — which hit SOL hardest because FTX/Alameda were major backers.

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Jan	−17%	Trend down, high vol	5	3/2	60%	**+$30**	+1.20R	5.40	−$5	1	$1,092	$1,122
Feb	+12%	Choppy, high vol	3	1/2	33%	**−$8**	−0.54R	0.23	−$10	2	$1,122	$1,114
Mar	+5%	Choppy	4	1/3	25%	**+$1**	+0.03R	1.05	−$11	3	$1,114	$1,115
Apr	−17%	Trend down	2	1/1	50%	**+$4**	+0.35R	3.52	−$1	1	$1,115	$1,118
May	−15%	Drift down, high vol	5	2/3	40%	**+$7**	+0.28R	1.46	−$10	2	$1,118	$1,125
Jun	−37%	Trend down, high vol	4	3/1	75%	**+$37**	+1.85R	8.16	−$5	1	$1,125	$1,162
Jul	+17%	Drift up, high vol	4	0/4	0%	**−$21**	−1.03R	0.00	−$21	4	$1,162	$1,142
Aug	−14%	Drift down	3	1/2	33%	**+$9**	+0.59R	2.65	−$5	2	$1,142	$1,151
Sep	−3%	Choppy	4	1/3	25%	**−$6**	−0.32R	0.59	−$10	2	$1,151	$1,144
Oct	+6%	Choppy, quiet	4	1/3	25%	**−$13**	−0.65R	0.20	−$13	2	$1,144	$1,131
Nov	−16%	Drift down	5	3/2	60%	**+$26**	+1.04R	3.43	−$5	1	$1,131	$1,157
Dec	−4%	Choppy, quiet	5	0/5	0%	**−$24**	−0.94R	0.00	−$24	5	$1,157	$1,134
Year	−64%		48	17/31	35%	**+$41**	+0.17R	1.29	−$31	6	$1,092	$1,134

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

48 trades, 17 winners (35%), net **+$41** — +0.17R per trade, profit factor 1.29. 7 of 12 trading months were profitable.

Textbook behaviour: the 6 months where BTC moved 15% or more made +$83, and the 4 near-flat months (under 10%) cost −$42. The big moves paid for the chop.

Best month **Jun** (+$37); worst **Dec** (−$24). Longest losing streak: **6** (30 Jun 2022 → 9 Aug 2022, −$26). Max drawdown −$31.

Longs −$52 · shorts +$93. Exits: 5 targets, 26 stops, 17 time exits (averaging +0.95R).

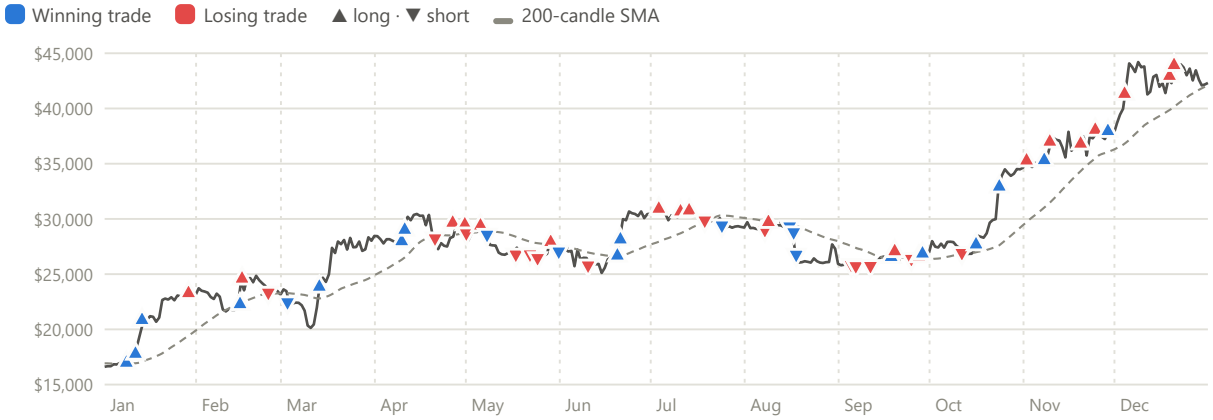
BITCOIN (BTC)

2023

Strong uptrend

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
+$105	**56**	**39%**	**+0.38R**	**−$35**	**5**	**+156%**
$1,134 → $1,239	22 W · 34 L	12 hit the 4R target	PF 1.61	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 42%

BTC price with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Strong uptrend. BTC went from $16,610 to $42,314 (+156%) with annualised volatility of 42% (its typical month: 49%). Trend efficiency of 0.38 means a fairly directional path. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 63% of the time and crossed it 61 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −23%.

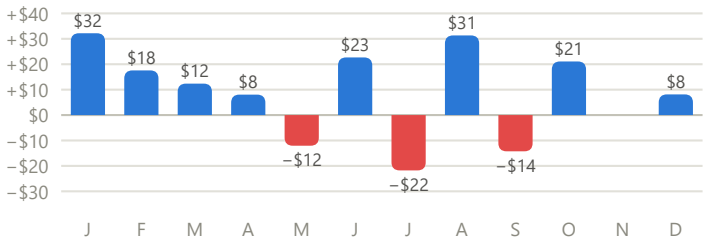
Biggest month up: **Jan** (+40%); biggest month down: **Aug** (−11%).

Backdrop: Recovery: March banking stress, then a grinding rally, accelerating in Oct–Dec on spot-ETF expectations. SOL rebounded from its post-FTX low.

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Jan	+40%	Trend up	5	3/2	60%	**+$32**	+1.29R	4.13	−$5	1	$1,134	$1,166
Feb	+0%	Choppy	2	1/1	50%	**+$18**	+1.76R	9.58	−$2	1	$1,166	$1,183
Mar	+23%	Drift up, high vol	3	2/1	67%	**+$12**	+0.82R	3.43	−$5	1	$1,183	$1,196
Apr	+3%	Choppy	5	2/3	40%	**+$8**	+0.32R	1.51	−$16	3	$1,196	$1,204
May	−7%	Choppy, quiet	7	1/6	14%	**−$12**	−0.34R	0.62	−$21	4	$1,204	$1,192
Jun	+12%	Drift up	4	3/1	75%	**+$23**	+1.13R	5.48	−$5	1	$1,192	$1,214
Jul	−4%	Range, quiet	4	0/4	0%	**−$22**	−1.09R	0.00	−$22	4	$1,214	$1,193
Aug	−11%	Trend down, quiet	6	4/2	67%	**+$31**	+1.04R	3.76	−$11	2	$1,193	$1,224
Sep	+4%	Range, quiet	7	1/6	14%	**−$14**	−0.41R	0.57	−$17	3	$1,224	$1,210
Oct	+29%	Trend up	3	2/1	67%	**+$21**	+1.41R	5.09	−$5	1	$1,210	$1,231
Nov	+9%	Choppy	6	2/4	33%	**$0**	+0.00R	1.00	−$16	3	$1,231	$1,231
Dec	+12%	Drift up	4	1/3	25%	**+$8**	+0.41R	1.74	−$11	3	$1,231	$1,239
Year	+156%		56	22/34	39%	**+$105**	+0.38R	1.61	−$35	5	$1,134	$1,239

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

56 trades, 22 winners (39%), net **+$105** — +0.38R per trade, profit factor 1.61. 9 of 12 trading months were profitable.

Textbook behaviour: the 3 months where BTC moved 15% or more made +$66, and the 6 near-flat months (under 10%) cost −$22. The big moves paid for the chop.

Best month **Jan** (+$32); worst **Jul** (−$22). Longest losing streak: **5** (20 Apr 2023 → 6 May 2023, −$26). Max drawdown −$35.

Longs +$109 · shorts −$4. Exits: 12 targets, 32 stops, 12 time exits (averaging +0.75R).

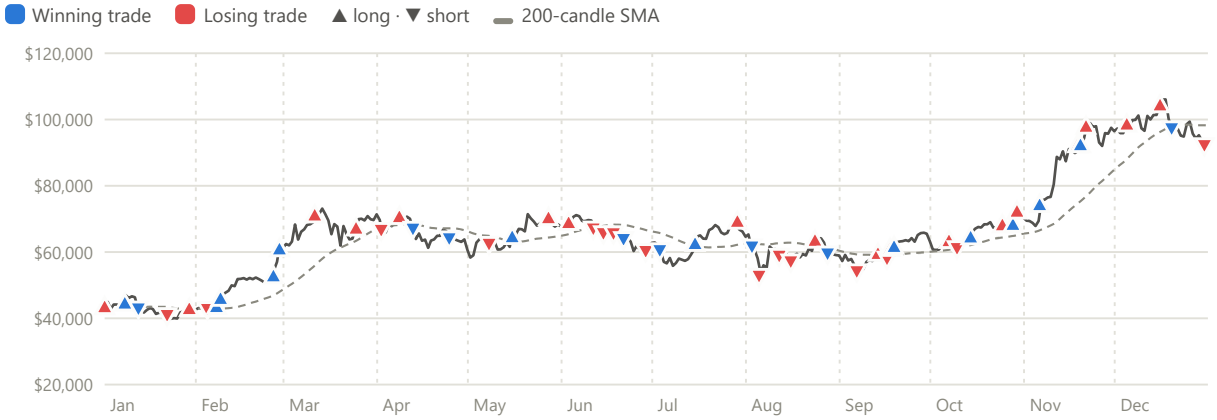
BITCOIN (BTC)

2024

Uptrend

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
+$51	53	38%	+0.19R	−$42	5	+121%
$1,239 → $1,290	20 W · 33 L	7 hit the 4R target	PF 1.30	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 52%

BTC price with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Uptrend. BTC went from $44,230 to $93,549 (+121%) with annualised volatility of 52% (its typical month: 49%). Trend efficiency of 0.28 means a fairly directional path. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 61% of the time and crossed it 53 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −34%.

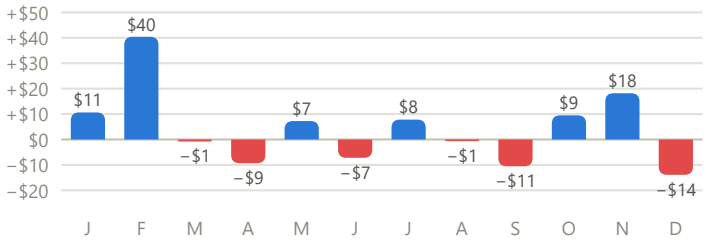
Biggest month up: **Feb** (+44%); biggest month down: **Apr** (−15%).

Backdrop: US spot BTC ETFs launched in January; BTC made a new high in March, halved in April, ranged through the summer (sharp August sell-off), then rallied on the November US election.

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Jan	+1%	Choppy	4	2/2	50%	+$11	+0.53R	2.00	−$6	1	$1,239	$1,250
Feb	+44%	Trend up	5	3/2	60%	+$40	+1.62R	4.67	−$11	2	$1,250	$1,290
Mar	+17%	Choppy, high vol	2	1/1	50%	−$1	−0.08R	0.85	−$5	1	$1,290	$1,289
Apr	−15%	Drift down	4	1/3	25%	−$9	−0.47R	0.26	−$13	3	$1,289	$1,280
May	+11%	Drift up	4	2/2	50%	+$7	+0.36R	1.71	−$6	1	$1,280	$1,287
Jun	−7%	Drift down	6	1/5	17%	−$7	−0.24R	0.73	−$22	4	$1,287	$1,280
Jul	+3%	Choppy	3	2/1	67%	+$8	+0.52R	2.48	−$5	1	$1,280	$1,288
Aug	−9%	Choppy, high vol	5	1/4	20%	−$1	−0.03R	0.97	−$21	4	$1,288	$1,287
Sep	+7%	Drift up	6	2/4	33%	−$11	−0.35R	0.49	−$21	4	$1,287	$1,277
Oct	+11%	Trend up, quiet	5	2/3	40%	+$9	+0.38R	1.60	−$10	2	$1,277	$1,286
Nov	+37%	Trend up	5	2/3	40%	+$18	+0.73R	2.15	−$5	1	$1,286	$1,304
Dec	−3%	Choppy	4	1/3	25%	−$14	−0.69R	0.13	−$14	2	$1,304	$1,290
Year	+121%		53	20/33	38%	+$51	+0.19R	1.30	−$42	5	$1,239	$1,290

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

53 trades, 20 winners (38%), net **+$51** — +0.19R per trade, profit factor 1.30. 6 of 12 trading months were profitable.

Textbook behaviour: the 4 months where BTC moved 15% or more made +$48, and the 6 near-flat months (under 10%) cost −$14. The big moves paid for the chop.

Best month **Feb** (+$40); worst **Dec** (−$14). Longest losing streak: **5** (27 May 2024 → 20 Jun 2024, −$27). Max drawdown −$42.

Longs +$58 · shorts −$7. Exits: 7 targets, 32 stops, 14 time exits (averaging +1.20R).

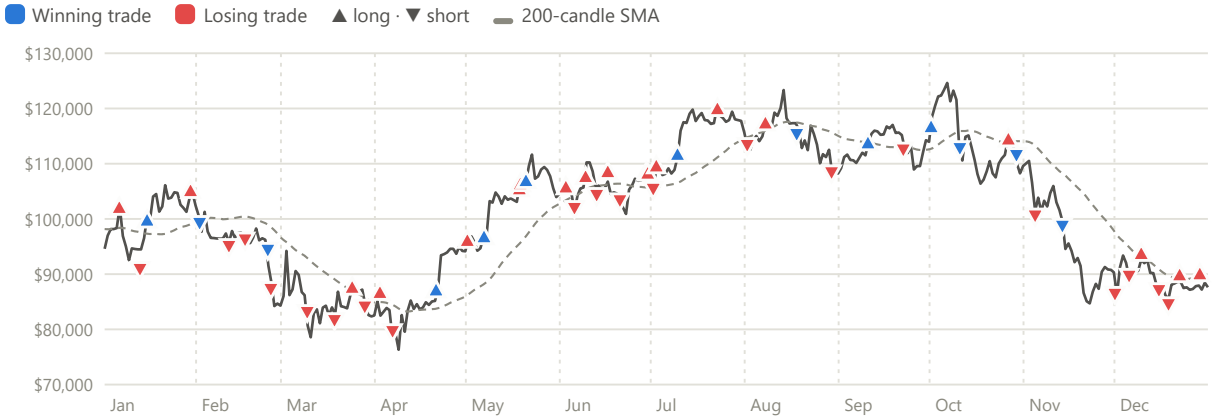
BITCOIN (BTC)

2025

Sideways / choppy

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
−$53	**52**	**25%**	**−0.20R**	**−$66**	**10**	**−6%**
$1,290 → $1,238	13 W · 39 L	3 hit the 4R target	PF 0.72	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 44%

BTC price with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Sideways / choppy. BTC went from $94,581 to $87,608 (−6%) with annualised volatility of 44% (its typical month: 49%). Trend efficiency of 0.05 means mostly a round trip — very choppy. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 44% of the time and crossed it 68 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −36%.

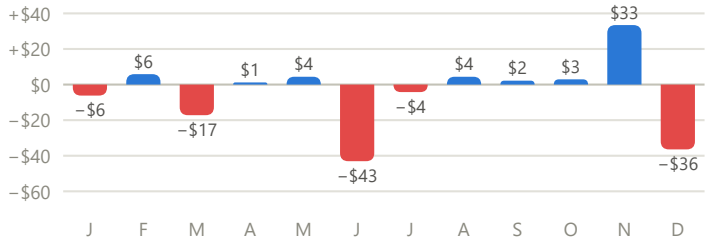
Biggest month up: **Apr** (+14%); biggest month down: **Feb** (−18%).

Backdrop: Described from the price data only.

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Jan	+9%	Drift up	3	1/2	33%	**−$6**	−0.41R	0.40	−$10	2	$1,290	$1,284
Feb	−18%	Trend down	5	2/3	40%	**+$6**	+0.23R	1.37	−$14	2	$1,284	$1,290
Mar	−2%	Choppy	4	0/4	0%	**−$17**	−0.86R	0.00	−$17	4	$1,290	$1,273
Apr	+14%	Drift up	4	1/3	25%	**+$1**	+0.06R	1.08	−$15	3	$1,273	$1,274
May	+11%	Drift up, quiet	5	2/3	40%	**+$4**	+0.18R	1.28	−$11	2	$1,274	$1,278
Jun	+2%	Choppy, quiet	8	0/8	0%	**−$43**	−1.08R	0.00	−$43	8	$1,278	$1,235
Jul	+8%	Drift up, quiet	4	1/3	25%	**−$4**	−0.21R	0.74	−$11	2	$1,235	$1,231
Aug	−6%	Choppy, quiet	3	1/2	33%	**+$4**	+0.29R	1.73	−$6	2	$1,231	$1,236
Sep	+5%	Drift up, quiet	3	1/2	33%	**+$2**	+0.15R	1.36	−$5	1	$1,236	$1,238
Oct	−4%	Range	3	2/1	67%	**+$3**	+0.20R	1.55	−$5	1	$1,238	$1,241
Nov	−18%	Trend down	3	2/1	67%	**+$33**	+2.23R	44.10	−$1	1	$1,241	$1,274
Dec	−3%	Choppy	7	0/7	0%	**−$36**	−1.04R	0.00	−$36	7	$1,274	$1,238
Year	−6%		52	13/39	25%	**−$53**	−0.20R	0.72	−$66	10	$1,290	$1,238

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

52 trades, 13 winners (25%), net **−$53** — −0.20R per trade, profit factor 0.72. 7 of 12 trading months were profitable.

The year never produced enough clean follow-through: big-move months made +$39, but the 8 near-flat months cost −$98. Breakouts kept reversing back into the range.

Best month **Nov** (+$33); worst **Jun** (−$43). Longest losing streak: **10** (3 Jun 2025 → 4 Jul 2025, −$54). Max drawdown −$66.

Longs −$31 · shorts −$22. Exits: 3 targets, 35 stops, 14 time exits (averaging +1.03R).

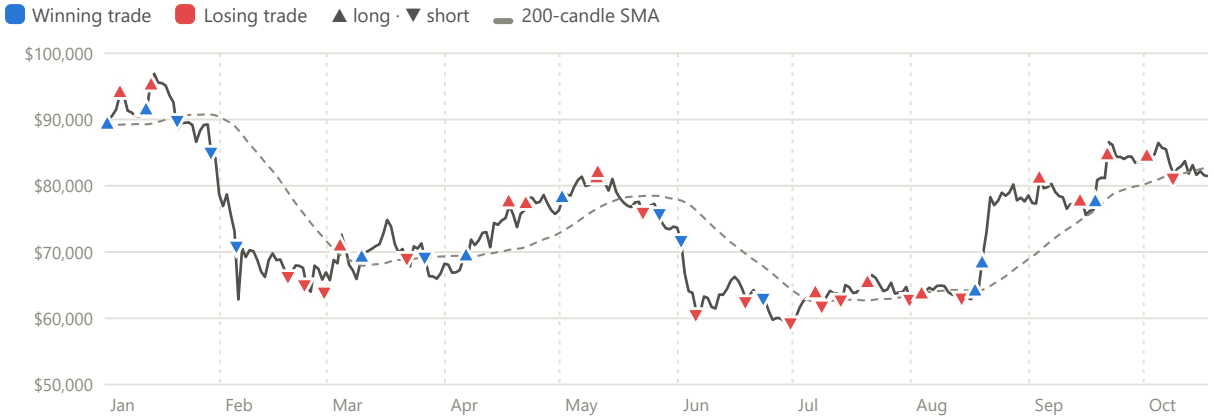
BITCOIN (BTC)

2026 (to mid-October)

Sideways / choppy

NET	TRADES	WIN RATE	AVG TRADE	MAX DRAWDOWN	LOSING STREAK	COIN MOVE
+$74	**43**	**35%**	**+0.35R**	**−$40**	**8**	**−7%**
$1,238 → $1,312	15 W · 28 L	8 hit the 4R target	PF 1.54	within the year	longest, in trades	volatility 41%

BTC price with every trade entry



How the market behaved

Sideways / choppy. BTC went from $88,800 to $81,456 (−7%) with annualised volatility of 41% (its typical month: 49%). Trend efficiency of 0.06 means mostly a round trip — very choppy. Price was above its 200-candle SMA 57% of the time and crossed it 48 times; the deepest peak-to-trough fall inside the year was −41%.

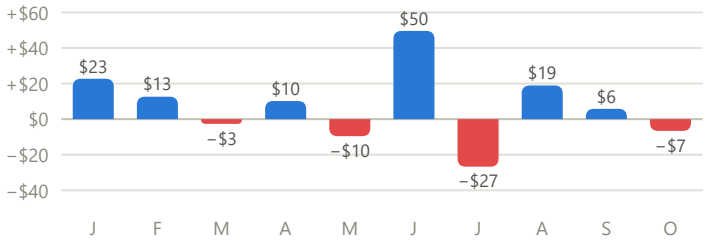
Biggest month up: **Aug** (+25%); biggest month down: **Jun** (−20%).

Backdrop: Described from the price data only (to mid-October).

Month by month

Month	Coin	Regime	Trades	W/L	Win %	Net	Avg	PF	Max DD	Streak	Start eq.	End eq.
Jan	−10%	Drift down	6	3/3	50%	**+$23**	+0.76R	2.42	−$11	2	$1,238	$1,260
Feb	−15%	Drift down	4	2/2	50%	**+$13**	+0.63R	2.22	−$10	2	$1,260	$1,273
Mar	+2%	Choppy	4	1/3	25%	**−$3**	−0.13R	0.83	−$10	2	$1,273	$1,270
Apr	+12%	Drift up	4	2/2	50%	**+$10**	+0.51R	2.00	−$10	2	$1,270	$1,281
May	−3%	Range, quiet	4	1/3	25%	**−$10**	−0.48R	0.40	−$16	3	$1,281	$1,271
Jun	−20%	Trend down	5	3/2	60%	**+$50**	+1.98R	6.20	−$10	2	$1,271	$1,321
Jul	+7%	Choppy, quiet	5	0/5	0%	**−$27**	−1.07R	0.00	−$27	5	$1,321	$1,294
Aug	+25%	Trend up, quiet	5	2/3	40%	**+$19**	+0.76R	2.42	−$13	3	$1,294	$1,313
Sep	+6%	Drift up, quiet	4	1/3	25%	**+$6**	+0.29R	1.43	−$11	2	$1,313	$1,319
Oct	−3%	Range, quiet	2	0/2	0%	**−$7**	−0.66R	0.00	−$7	2	$1,319	$1,312
Year	−7%		43	15/28	35%	**+$74**	+0.35R	1.54	−$40	8	$1,238	$1,312

Monthly net ($)



How the strategy did — and why

43 trades, 15 winners (35%), net **+$74** — +0.35R per trade, profit factor 1.54. 6 of 10 trading months were profitable.

Textbook behaviour: the 2 months where BTC moved 15% or more made +$69, and the 5 near-flat months (under 10%) cost −$40. The big moves paid for the chop.

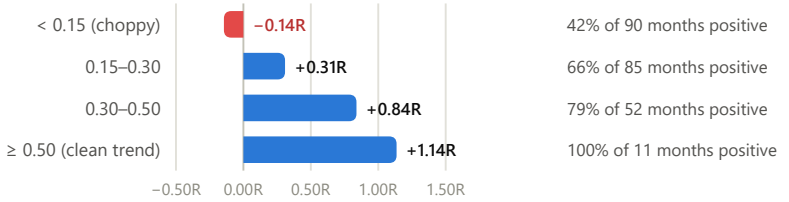
Best month **Jun** (+$50); worst **Jul** (−$27). Longest losing streak: **8** (30 Jun 2026 → 17 Aug 2026, −$40). Max drawdown −$40.

Longs +$47 · shorts +$27. Exits: 8 targets, 24 stops, 11 time exits (averaging +0.83R).

4 · What kind of market does it need?

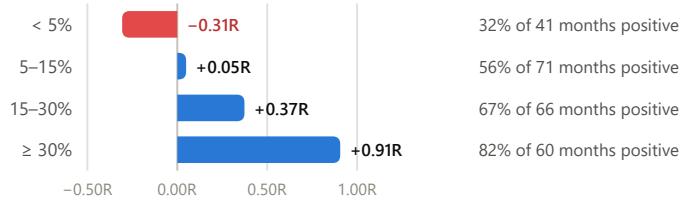
Every month of every coin (238 coin-months with trades), grouped by how the coin behaved that month. Bars show the average result per trade in those months.

Trend efficiency of the month



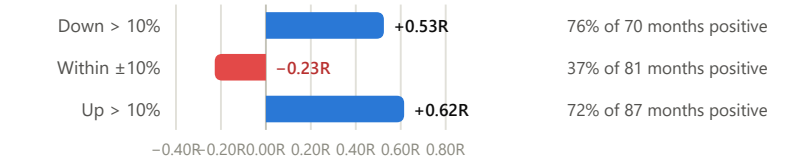
Efficiency = net move ÷ total distance travelled by daily closes. Choppy months (< 0.15) lose; clean trends make more than +1R per trade.

Size of the coin's move in the month



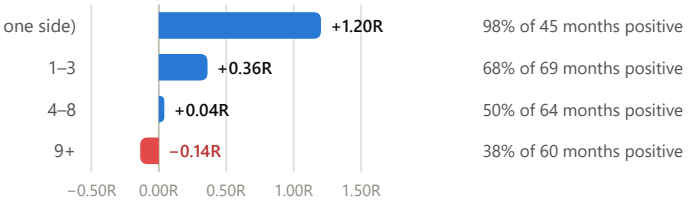
The single clearest pattern: months where the coin moved under 5% average −0.31R per trade; 30%+ months average +0.91R.

Direction of the month



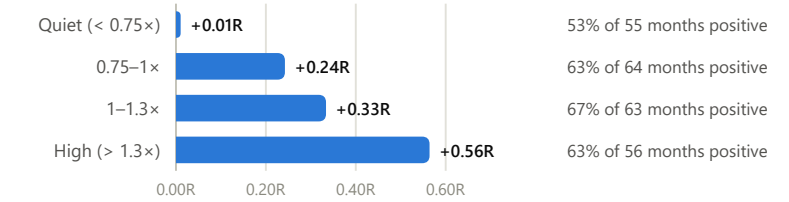
Direction does not matter — up and down months both pay. Only the flat middle loses. The SMA filter makes the strategy symmetric.

How often price crossed the 200-candle SMA



Months that stayed on one side of the SMA made +1.20R per trade (98% profitable). Whipsaw months (9+ crosses) lose.

Volatility vs the coin's own typical month



Higher volatility helps, but less than direction and cleanness do. Quiet months roughly break even.

In one sentence

The strategy needs the coin to **travel a long way in one direction within a few weeks** — up or down. It is hurt most by months that go nowhere: flat, choppy months crossing the trend line again and again, when breakouts fail, reverse and hit the stop at the middle band.

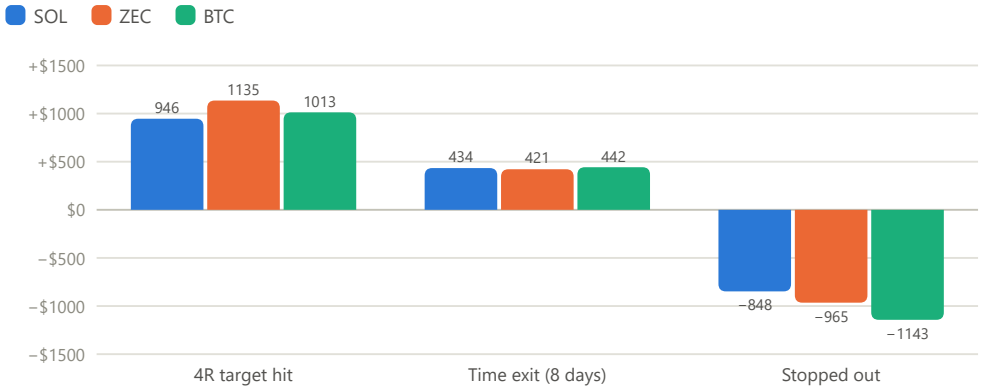
Important: these conditions are measured *after* each month is over. They explain when the strategy makes money, but nobody knows in advance which month will be choppy — section 6 tests whether any of it can be detected at entry.

5 · SOL vs ZEC vs BTC — why the results differ

Key metrics side by side

	SOL	ZEC	BTC
Net profit (6 years)	**+$532**	**+$592**	**+$312**
Held-out 2023→	+$304	+$304	+$178
Average trade	+0.35R	+0.36R	+0.17R
Profit factor	1.60	1.60	1.26
Win rate	39%	39%	35%
4R target-hit rate	16%	17%	14%
Average win / loss	+2.38R / −0.93R	+2.41R / −0.98R	+2.35R / −0.98R
Typical monthly volatility	96%	102%	49%
Band half-width at entry (≈ stop)	6.5%	6.3%	3.1%
Profit lost if costs double	−8%	−7%	−30%
Same with a 3R target	+$417	+$474	+$305
Long avg / short avg	+0.39R / +0.30R	+0.42R / +0.29R	+0.16R / +0.18R
Funding paid over 6 years	−$22	−$21	−$29
Profitable months	45 of 74	55 of 81	46 of 86
Max drawdown	−$64	−$78	−$85

Where the money comes from (total $, by exit type)



Only 14–17% of trades reach the target, but they earn ≈ +3.9R each. Time exits average ≈ +0.9R — trades still open after 8 days are usually still moving the right way. Stops cost ≈ −1.03R each.

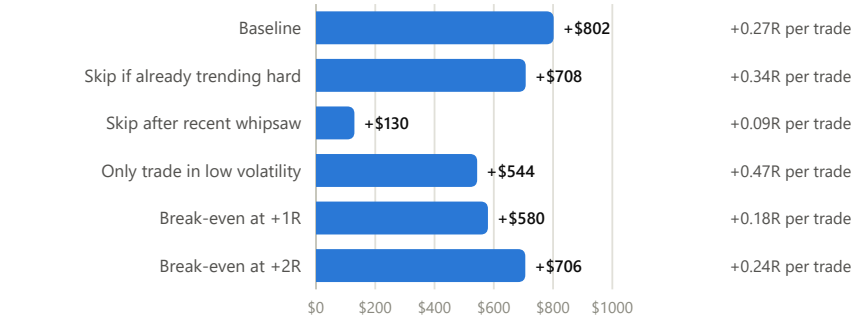
What explains the gap

- **Same payoff shape on every coin** — wins ≈ +2.4R, losses ≈ −1.0R. The whole difference is **how often breakouts follow through**: 39% winners on SOL/ZEC vs 35% on BTC.
- **BTC is about half as volatile** (49% vs ~99%) so its stops are half as wide and fees take a bigger bite: doubling costs removes 30% of BTC's profit vs 8% of SOL's.
- **BTC's two losing years** (2021, 2025) were its least efficient years. SOL and ZEC also had choppy years but kept enough large swings to stay positive.
- **Diversification is real:** monthly results barely move together (correlation SOL–ZEC 0.02, SOL–BTC 0.24, ZEC–BTC 0.11). Combined, the worst drawdown was −$93 vs −$227 if each coin's worst had hit at once.
- **Hypothesis, not tested:** BTC is a deeper, more arbitraged market, so 4h band breaks revert more often.

6 · What could improve it — ideas tested properly

Each idea was run inside the bot (a skipped signal frees the slot for the next one). Thresholds were set on trades **before 2023** and applied unchanged to **2023→2026, the fair test**.

2023→2026 net profit for each idea (all three coins)



Idea	Before 2023 (avg · net)	2023→ (avg · net)	2023→ max DD	Verdict
Baseline	+0.30R · +$634	+0.27R · +$802	−$93	—
Skip if the last 10 days already trended hard	+0.39R · +$577	+0.34R · +$708	−$88	**Better per trade in both halves**, less total profit
Skip after recent whipsaw (≥4 SMA crosses / 30 d)	+0.28R · +$295	+0.09R · +$130	−$80	Rejected
Only trade in low volatility (bottom third)	+0.29R · +$249	+0.47R · +$544	−$67	Helped in one half only — unproven
Break-even stop at +1R	+0.21R · +$476	+0.18R · +$580	−$86	Rejected — worse in both
Break-even stop at +2R	+0.26R · +$563	+0.24R · +$706	−$99	Rejected — worse in both
Halve risk after 5 losses (sizing)	—	+$735	−$80	Mixed — all-years DD −$103 vs −$93

Facts known at entry vs trade result (low / middle / high third)

Condition at the signal	Before 2023	2023→	Same pattern?
Trend efficiency, last 60 candles (10 days)	+0.44R / +0.40R / +0.06R	+0.53R / +0.16R / +0.12R	**Yes**
ATR% rank vs the last 90 days	+0.44R / +0.26R / +0.20R	+0.58R / +0.02R / +0.24R	Partly
SMA200 slope over 30 candles	+0.25R / +0.39R / +0.22R	+0.47R / +0.14R / +0.15R	No
Distance from SMA200 in ATRs (stretch)	+0.22R / +0.39R / +0.28R	+0.38R / +0.28R / +0.16R	No
Bollinger band width (% of price)	+0.40R / +0.39R / +0.11R	+0.28R / +0.21R / +0.38R	No

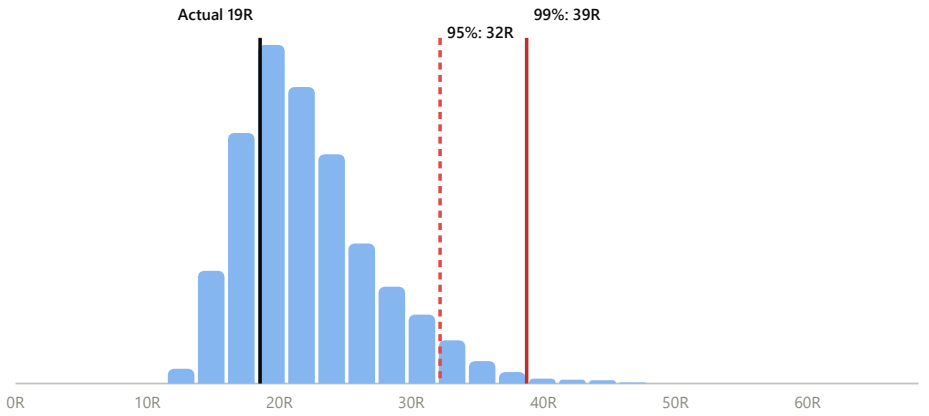
The two consistent signals point the same way: the best breakouts start **from compression** — after ~10 quiet, directionless days and low volatility — not after a move has already run. Five conditions were tried, so one full pass could partly be luck.

What this means

- **No filter beat the plain strategy on total profit.** The chop that hurts it is only visible after the fact; trailing proxies remove good trades along with bad ones.
- **Break-even stops hurt** because winners typically dip about −0.4R before working; moving the stop early kills them.
- **Keep the rules frozen.** The one promising idea (skip breakouts after a strong 10-day trend) is a "fewer, better trades" option — worth paper-trading alongside, not replacing, the baseline.
- **Not yet tested:** letting winners run past 8 days (time exits average +0.9R), a portfolio-level size brake, more uncorrelated coins.

7 · Risk planning — what to expect when trading it

How deep could the combined drawdown get? (all three coins, in R)



The same 1,008 trades reshuffled into 3,000 random orders. The real history (19R) was on the lucky side of the median (21R) — plan for the 95th percentile. 1R = your risk per trade.

	Actual max DD	Typical (median)	95% worst case	99% worst case	At $1 risk (95%)
SOL	12.8R	13.7R	**21.6R**	26.1R	$22
ZEC	15.6R	14.5R	**22.7R**	27.9R	$23
BTC	17.0R	21.0R	**33.4R**	40.3R	$33
All three	18.5R	21.3R	**32.2R**	38.7R	$32

Expectations at your planned $1 risk per trade

TRADES PER MONTH	EXPECTED PER MONTH	PLAN FOR DRAWDOWN	WIN RATE
12	**$3.5**	**$32**	**37%**
all three coins	average, based on 2023→	95% worst case	most trades lose

- Scale is linear: at $5 risk multiply every dollar figure by 5 (drawdown plan ≈ $161).
- A losing streak of 8–10 trades on one coin is **normal** — it happened SOL 2×, ZEC 1×, BTC 2× in six years.
- Recoveries can be slow: BTC's worst drawdown took 560 days to recover.
- Many individual months lose money (92 of 241 coin-months); judge it over quarters, not weeks.

Stop-and-review triggers (set from this history, not tuned)

- **Drawdown deeper than 39R** across the three coins (beyond the 99% case) → stop and re-examine.
- **Rolling 50-trade result below −14R** (worse than the worst 50-trade stretch ever seen) → stop.
- **4R target-hit rate below ~10% over 60+ trades** (history: 14–17%) → the follow-through the edge depends on has gone.
- Otherwise **do not change the rules** mid-drawdown — every losing stretch in this report recovered without changes.

8 · My take: is this strategy recommended?

Verdict

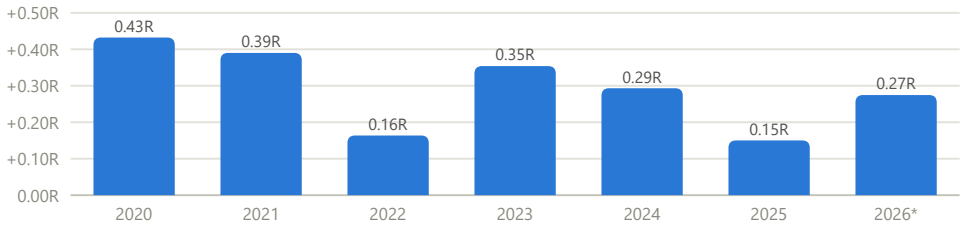
Yes, as a small, rules-only strategy — not as an income source. Across six years and 1,008 trades it earned +0.28R per trade after realistic Binance costs and funding, made money on all three coins, held up in 2023–26 (never used for tuning), and worked on a coin (ZEC) it had never seen.

It is a classic trend-following breakout: **it does not predict or adapt to the market — it waits for big, clean moves and keeps losses small in between.** That is why it survived the 2021 mania, the 2022 crash and the 2024–26 ranges with only two losing coin-years.

Scorecard

Question	Answer	Evidence
Profitable after realistic costs?	**Yes**	+$1436 over 6 years; still +$1258 with double costs
Works outside its tuning data?	**Yes**	+$786 in 2023→; ZEC +$592 never tuned
Free of look-ahead / repainting?	**Yes**	0 mismatches in 300 truncation tests
Consistent across regimes?	**Mostly**	20 of 22 coin-years positive or flat; chop costs money
Adapts to changing markets?	**No**	No filter tested improved total profit
Edge decaying?	**Not yet**	+0.30R per trade before 2023 vs +0.27R after
Easy to sit through?	**No**	37% win rate, 8–10 loss streaks, long recoveries

Is the edge holding up? Average result per trade, by year (all three coins)



*2026 to mid-October. No clear downward trend: 2023 (out-of-sample) was one of the best years; 2025 was the weakest because BTC lost money in a sideways year.

Recommended setup

- **Coins:** SOL and ZEC at full size; BTC at half size (or skip) — weakest edge, most cost-sensitive.
- **Rules:** exactly as tested — Bollinger 20/2σ, SMA200 filter, stop at the middle band, **4R target**, 48-candle time exit.
- **Risk:** start at **$1 per trade**. Plan for a ≈$32 drawdown; expect about $3.5 a month on average (many single months will be negative).
- **Execution:** place the target as a resting limit order (maker fee) and the stop at entry; never move the stop early.
- **Review:** log every trade and compare with this report each month; use the stop triggers on the previous page.

Proven vs still a hypothesis

Supported by the data

- Profitable on SOL, ZEC, BTC after costs and funding
- Big clean moves (either direction) pay; flat months lose
- SOL and ZEC ≈ 2× BTC's edge per trade
- Coins are nearly uncorrelated — combining them halves drawdowns
- Break-even stops and whipsaw filters make it worse

Needs more testing

- That the edge continues — the 4R target was picked with hindsight
- Other coins: these three were partly chosen because they did best
- Skipping breakouts after a strong 10-day trend (better per trade, less total)
- Low-volatility-only trading (helped in one half only)
- Letting winners run past 8 days
- Why BTC follows through less often

Backtests describe the past. Past results — even carefully tested, out-of-sample ones — do not guarantee future returns. Trade only money you can afford to lose.